

2EQ IN A NUTSHELL

As an interesting experiment, and just to see what might happen, I recently tried using AI to condense down something I had written to a 20 minute presentation - as you might see on the TED stage etc. But this didn't really work given the overall depth and scale of the subject matter. At first it was quite good, although a little clunky. But as things progressed it became more difficult to compress, and by the end it was pretty much back to full detail. Nevertheless, in overall terms it was still quite a valuable exercise, so I thought I would share the results -

On screen: The Blind Spot of the Human Mind: A Path to True Well-being

We live in a time of incredible paradox. On one hand, we seem to be facing an increasing number of existential threats: climate change, geopolitical instability, the future of AI. Whilst on the other side we also stand on the brink of unprecedented scientific progress, all of which seems to offer an equal measure of hope. And through it all, we just can't figure out which one of these horses is going to win the race, and decide our ultimate fate. A relentless torrent of information bombards us, each promising the next big thing, the most urgent crisis, the definitive solution. Yet, for millions - and as Thoreau once said - the underlying human condition for so many people remains one of quiet desperation.

We are advanced, but are we truly well?

What if, amidst this overwhelming noise, something far more fundamental is still being overlooked?

I'm going to propose here that our collective inability to find lasting well-being points to a singular, pervasive problem.

If it is true, then it is an issue that stands apart in a sense, untouched by all these external changes, all these hopes and fears. It could be our true problem, our core problem, the one which - if unaddressed - will forever lock us into our current struggles. But also the one which - if it is addressed - could change everything, for everyone, and also very rapidly. It might even be a unifying view.

I understand that this is a monumental claim. History is littered with grand pronouncements about breakthroughs and paradigm shifts. But if this one is accurate, it really will fundamentally alter our understanding of human experience. So you would be right to be skeptical, but I would also ask you to grant this the benefit of the doubt for at least long enough to consider the hypothesis. As Carl Sagan said, "Extraordinary claims require extraordinary proof." But I believe compelling and empirical proof is available here, if you are willing to look.

My aim in this sense will not even be to convince you this is true, though I clearly believe it is. The real point is that this will certainly not be something you have ever heard before, and that it is also something that might stand to change everything, and in ways we had never imagined possible. So my only aim is to invite you to consider: "What if?" So that, by the end, you can say that you grasp the basic outlines of what is being claimed, along with at least some of its very dramatic implications.

So let's begin.

On screen: The Glitch in Our Software

Something isn't quite right with us. We've picked at this puzzle for centuries, yet human psychology remains largely enigmatic. We dissect it, measure it, theorize about it. But our personal experiences – our consciousness, our motivations, our often-conflicted tendencies – remain deeply confusing. The persistent dissatisfaction many feel, even in lives of privilege, suggests something profoundly amiss.

My argument here will be this: there really is a profound problem with human life, but that its true origins and nature have been deeply misunderstood. We constantly look externally for a cause that is actually coming from within us. And seeing that issue turns out to be quite the challenge; because it likes to hide. So for that, we need to go back in time, to a time before it was there.

Consider our evolutionary trajectory. The forms of intelligence we see in ourselves and other species are all part of a kind of cognitive arms race. But we seem to have won the lotto in that sense, and suddenly leapt ahead. We acquired a hardware upgrade: a uniquely capable brain structure. And this allowed us to run new, sophisticated software: abstract thought, complex language, imagination.

Unlike other animals, who live in perpetual submission to genetically inherited patterns of behavior - or what we tend to call instinct - we suddenly gained the ability not only to act in more adaptive ways - but also to reflect on our own minds, reprogram our thinking, and even to program the minds of others through the development of culture. And this led to incredible cognitive heights, but this new software also seems to have come with a critical and unexpected bug. A virus, if you will – an issue so ubiquitous, and so deeply embedded, that we've come to simply imagine this afflicted state is what it now means to be "normal."

The result of this hidden knot in our emotional fabric, so to speak, is profound internal conflict and confusion. This entanglement has also made it nearly impossible to distinguish our natural, healthy psychological system from this added, anomalous activity. We mistake the pathology for the baseline. And this is the key insight: when we observe the complexities of human behavior, we're actually looking at two things, not one. And precisely because this twisted state is universally expressed and causes so much confusion, this added layer of subversive activity has remained hidden in plain sight. It is the one thing we really need to know, but also the one thing we just can't see. And one of the reasons we can't see it is because it is everywhere. Examples of people without this added complex do exist, but they are rare, and certainly not explained very well within our current cultural framework.

Understanding the anatomy of this situation is critical. The ability to functionally separate these two components – the innate, healthy functioning, and this acquired, dysfunctional layer – is key to both practical and psychological empowerment. Because this added phenomenon is largely unconscious by default, understanding it consciously finally allows us to look at it, rather than merely look from it, as we normally do.

Crucially, this added event is singular and extrinsic. It has a single active origin, and while its emergence might be natural, it is not native to us in the sense that it is necessary or unavoidable. This implies, shockingly, that it can be removed. Not easily as it turns out, given how deeply embedded it is - but given its profound impact, just the mere possibility of its removal is a bombshell, fundamentally altering our understanding of human potential and the very nature of happiness itself.

Strangely, this insight isn't even that difficult to grasp once it is revealed. It's just been extraordinarily well hidden. And here lies the real issue: this problem is deeply unsettling to confront. The resistance we might feel to even considering its presence in the first place is a primary symptom of the problem itself.

This powerful emotional undertow immediately exposes where we've been stuck, and also what getting ourselves unstuck might now demand. As in every revolution, freedom belongs to the brave.

On screen: The Problem of Imagined Realities

How did this psychological virus arise? Consider imagination for a moment. It's an astonishing faculty, allowing us to plan, innovate, create. But it also emerged as part of a complex navigational system that constantly generates an extended overlay on our direct perception of reality – a "pseudo-reality" if you will. But what we rarely stop to consider is just how vast and ceaseless this extended construct is, or that this "simulated" aspect also includes all of our past, our future, and most of what we emotionally experience in the present as "real."

We are so deeply invested in this projection that we are largely unaware we are even doing it. In essence, we experience two types of reality: one actually real, the other just a complex framework of spurious beliefs, merely our best guess at any moment, an artifact of our own mental functioning.

This second layer is designed to feel real – that's its purpose after all – but ultimately, it's actually just a convoluted trick of the mind. So what if our capacity for projecting reality, which has been so beneficial, also gave rise to certain "felt realities" that were simply not true? And what if these imagined realities, in the wrong combination, caused profound emotional turmoil because we believed them anyway? What if we couldn't "unthink" these ideas precisely because they weren't real, having no factual basis to contradict them? I mean, if I tell you all unicorns are pink, how can you factually refute that? Can you show me a unicorn that isn't pink, to prove me wrong? No.

Therefore, what if your newly augmented capacity for imagination was smart enough to make some educated guesses about what is really going on in life, in millions of small ways, but what if it wasn't quite smart enough to get it right when it came to a few of the biggest questions of all? And what if one or two really basic errors in what we might call our 'cosmological' or 'existential' context had the unfortunate ability to cause a truly devastating emotional dilemma.

How would you contain the resulting crisis? You likely wouldn't even know you were confronting something that wasn't genuinely there. So, the unconscious, responsible for this overlay, would eventually be forced to deconstruct the emerging conflict to prevent conscious attention from spiraling into an endless, irresolvable problem. It wouldn't even know where this fire had come from necessarily, it would only know it has to put it out. And to do this, it could only be able to use whatever it had on hand at the time.

What we see is that this newfound capacity for imagination, while being immensely powerful, has also managed to completely freak us out. There may be no actual problem, but the mere fact that we imagine there is one paradoxically creates one. It's like a passenger screaming that the plane's wing is on fire - the fire might not be real, but the ensuing panic could certainly cause a lot of trouble.

In particular, we are talking about a singular and very specific event in this regard, a situation that inevitably leads to a kind of functional deadlock. The unconscious becomes tasked with permanently concealing this explosive possibility from conscious view. But in a system so deeply built around awareness as one of its defining functions, keeping something so vital hidden will always create deep, persistent stress. And who feels that stress? The conscious self feels it, even though it's the one aspect of this complex system that is not being allowed to become aware of what's truly going on. So it's forever caught in the middle of something it can't understand. Indeed, it's the one thing it's not allowed to understand. So, if we want to see it, we will need to act strongly against instructions. We

will need to be a "bad monkey" for a moment, and rattle our cage a little. And it is implied that this might be a bit disturbing.

In which case we might ask you: How do you feel? Does it make sense that there might be something very deeply wrong? That the internal lights have been mysteriously dimmed in this way? And socially, that we all seem scattered, no longer able to find that unifying thread we once had?

Do you genuinely know why you feel that way? You can't know, and this is the point - because if you did, the concealment wouldn't be working. And that wouldn't be good, because your own unconscious is basically doing all of this to prevent you from going insane. And yet, you only need to begin to see how all of this works in order to gain a degree of empowerment, and also to begin to undo some of this mess - like a fireman running back into a burning building, while everyone else is running out.

This convoluted dynamic, this constant struggle between our system's intrinsic integrity and this added, extrinsic emergency containment, manifests in many ways. What appears chaotic and infinitely varied across individuals is, in fact, just different expressions of the same underlying conflict. It's like two slippery combatants locked in a perpetual fight – one trying to hide something, the other trying to expose it. But if ever the latter succeeds, the result is not the release of tension it sought, but immediate panic, as the former then needs to step back in and re-bury the offending artifact with one of its subversive concealment patterns, or what we might call its various "limbs."

Hence, we sometimes use the metaphor of having a big unconscious octopus with us in our little conscious fish tank of a mind. The whole event - what we call normal life - looks very messy until you understand the underlying dynamic, and particularly how to differentiate these two events. Then, it appears almost like clockwork. It's not inherently complicated; it was just superbly hidden, right in front of us in a sense.

Obviously, this "octopus" is very good at hiding in plain sight, being able to mimic any part of our internal environment, so as to remain invisible to conscious awareness, but it also generates a huge amount of "ink" at times, in the form of even more outrageous fictions than the original mistakes that caused all this trouble in the first place. The original erroneous beliefs really are just figments of our imagination, but because we believe them so strongly, our unconscious is then forced to hide real facts from us. So we throw out the baby and keep the bathwater, and this is why there is so much mess and confusion.

This creates a kind of out-of-control "bullshit generator." We fill the world with endless dramatic fictions, while burying important truths beneath an ocean of unreality. We escape from real life into distraction and fantasy. Essentially, our ability to use imagination to fabricate things that aren't actually true is what caused the problem in the first place, but now we use the very same function to try to tidy up the mess we made, with the result being even more imagination - but this time in a way that is completely out of control, and for the most part totally untethered from reality.

This is why rational cognition – logic, science, empiricism, critical thinking – is so profoundly important. We're not just passively observing reality as we imagine we are, or calmly figuring things out. We're actually standing in a raging torrent, being ceaselessly dragged backward toward fantasy and error. And in this context just standing still requires considerable mental fortitude, a capacity fewer and fewer possess.

This makes rigorous rational dialogue precious – it's where we learn these skills, sharpen our logical and empirical blades, and develop safeguards against this pervasive corruption of reality. Yet, these challenging mental arenas are now largely empty, leaving this "unhinged from reality" aspect of the octopus free to wreak havoc without any obvious limits. People are increasingly willing to believe

almost anything, except what's actually true. This is the real reason why. It's not just passive erosion of healthy cognition, but a powerful, unconscious driving force.

Of course, there are many other "limbs" of this creeping process of concealment, some with far greater negative impacts than a few adult fairy tales. But we will tend to focus on this one here at first if only because it produces so much noise and confusion, thereby preventing us from picking out truth from lies. We need to at least remove a bit of this ink from the fish tank, just so that we can see. As they say – first, free the mind.

On screen: The Great Reveal: A Return to "Normal"

So, the claim is this: something vast lurks in our depths. An explosive functional crisis. An entirely separate, secondary agenda, playing a game the conscious mind cannot directly access.

This added entity has two parts: the underlying explosive potential, and then all of the unconscious mechanisms that are preventing that from ever occurring again. It is as if this octopus is hiding a grenade, if only because the conscious mind keeps wanting to get hold of it and pull the pin. The octopus and the grenade are not the same thing in this sense, but from the conscious perspective, both events remain equally mysterious and frustratingly slippery to even see, let alone really understand.

This secondary agenda is inherently dysfunctional. It is implied. There is essentially nothing wrong with the functioning that produces this simmering explosive outcome. It's like having a disturbing film loaded into a projector, but the canister is locked. So to prevent any distress, the operator starts tearing the projector apart in order to stop the movie. Basically, to control this potential crisis, our healthy functioning must be subverted. And for those with a high degree of integrity, this will obviously be worse – hence: genius borders on madness. But for those with lower integrity, it's clearly going to be easier – hence: ignorance is bliss. But for most, the result is always the same - hardwired tension and relentless, low-grade discontent. It is an impossible puzzle for the conscious mind.

This might sound bleak. It may even make you squirm a little. But consider the implication: if this is true, what would your unconscious reaction be to this information being revealed in this way, even in outline? Resistance, right? Psychological defenses would come online, warning lights flashing. Everything would tell you to back away, turn around, and run for the hills. And this is precisely how the problem has maintained itself over time.

The key insight here is that there are two things going on, not one, and one is not intrinsic to us. We are afflicted. And it's serious.

This isn't your current understanding of yourself, right? No. It's quite a shift in perspective.

This critical insight has been entirely concealed, and for very good reasons. But it might also be the tiny fuse to the biggest stick of dynamite ever.

Think about the implications of this being true - that we have completely mistaken what is actually an added and unnecessary body of activity for who we naturally are.

Consider that our entire lives have come to include this added conflict as being intrinsic to us rather than optional, and also that the world as a whole reflects this same elementary confusion. Then think about how rapidly its cover might be blown in this sense, and what the consequences might be if - very soon after that - it was able to be securely removed and undone.

It represents a type of change, and a depth of social transformation, that we rarely consider possible. And all based on something that was, in actuality, right in front of us all along. It would be the best possible news in a sense, an overwhelming potential, but also one that is paradoxically based on the worst of all assumptions: that our current state is not what we think it is.

Do you see the underlying problem here already? The psychological and social dilemma? It was hidden in the perfect spot: somewhere nobody would ever think to look. Yet this part – that there's a deep problem – isn't new. As far back as the 1970s, Ernest Becker proposed that humans are essentially "on fire" in some deep sense. For most adults this fire is now only smoldering away, but the massive pile of wet blankets they use to contain it still causes many problems. It makes them fragile, defensive, confused. And this aspect really isn't left in much doubt now, even though it might be a very uncomfortable starting point. A view named Terror Management Theory has since empirically validated this insight: something profound and terrifying really is hidden in our depths.

Yet, such views never did capture this issue with enough resolution to tease apart the aspects that truly matter: that this added activity is singular, integrated, and extrinsic. It is not part of who we are. It is real, and everywhere, but not innate. It is a disease, an added and unnecessary affliction. It's just something we are doing, something we can't stop ourselves from doing, but it is not who we really are.

Crucially, the one important thing overlooked is that it can be entirely removed, as indicated. Not without help, certainly, but the mere existence of this possibility is not something we generally assume.

We don't know this. So we just accept it. We call this restless confusion "being normal," just as a computer can't see its own virus; that's what makes the virus active. It is the one thing we can't see, and so we can't affect it. And this means we remain entirely at its mercy, at least until we are prepared to look.

Here we see the power of critical insight. The big issue is not only the loaded aversion, but the confusion this subversive activity generates. It has muddied the waters so much that the nature and origins of the underlying healthy system have been obscured, making clear differentiation impossible. We simply don't know what a fish tank without an octopus even looks like, or how different that might be for our little conscious goldfish. But the moment that cover is blown, an entirely different sort of process emerges, as confusion begins to transform into empowerment.

In particular, what we see are practical options opening up in light of such awareness. Like a computer virus once again, the moment it is isolated and understood, suddenly an antivirus program becomes possible. It might be a very dark place to look, but if we can, suddenly we gain power over it – the reward for insight and bravery.

You only need to be prepared to examine it more closely. And to do that, you need the missing anatomy. You need to see what the healthy system looks like in the absence of the affliction, to be able to subtract the signal from the noise. This is what all the confusion has prevented us from doing. But it also means that awareness alone has power in this context, given that awareness is what is being withheld - which means that once you see it, you really can't unsee it again. It's like someone explaining how a magician does a trick; from then on, you only see the trick, not the illusion. Your eyes are open.

To be clear, however, we need to distinguish the initial insight here from the downstream transformation. First of all you get the ability to see this vast and sprawling process of unconscious subversion, but only later on do we gain the ability to functionally remove it. That is a much deeper and more important shift, but without the first the second is impossible.

So without that missing map, we remain trapped in the illusion. We can't see the octopus, even though it is sitting there right in front of us. And in that state, this pervasive subversion will always force us into various patterns of management as we seek out small pockets of stable happiness amid all the noise and confusion.

These patterns are always more demanding than natural well-being, and never lead to effortless fulfillment. Even at our best, a restless dissatisfaction eats away at us. This is not our natural state, but we can't see it, because not knowing is what this added activity is all about.

This is the profound news here: this condition can be understood, manipulated, and under certain (currently rare) circumstances, completely undone. This is certainly not something Becker claimed, nor is it part of the current Terror Management Theory framework, or any other contemporary scientific view for that matter.

It is obviously not for me to say that any of this is true - that will be for others to figure out in due course. But if it is, then it is a monumental leap, a true paradigm shift in the sense Thomas Kuhn defined such. And yes, this is a big claim once again, but not making this plain can often prevent people from grasping its full implications. So we are forced to spell it out clearly.

The ability to functionally differentiate these two psychologically fused events is a singular core insight that immediately opens up entirely new scientific territory, while comprehensively explaining away many important mistakes in preceding views.

To have blindly included such a vast and dynamic body of added activity in our general pictures of humanity has always been an egregious mistake, one that has been repeated endlessly throughout history in thousands of different forms. And so, while the emerging view sets the stage for a very deep process of change, the quite simple insight it is based on also turns out to be radically disrespectful by implication. It replaces weak, vague, or convoluted complexity with a singular, powerful, and simple model – a dynamic functional anatomy that ultimately leaves very few stones unturned. And that is only in theory. In practice it is even more dramatic – in that it points not only to the fact that the entire crisis might be released, but also how.

We should also be clear: we are not only indicating some sort of subtle mitigation. No temporary effect. We are not talking about any kind of ongoing practice. We are not speaking about meditation. This is not a lawn you would need to constantly mow. It would simply be gone. Entirely gone. Once. Forever.

Clearly, it's a lot to take in. But the claim is not vague or equivocal. It is a distinct and empirical reality, entirely falsifiable in practice.

There is direct proof available, as we will see. And that proof may not be long in coming.

In the early stages all of this will be easy to deny or dismiss. It will simply be ignored and avoided, especially by weaker or less intelligent people. But this is itself just the octopus in action, do you see?

So it is inevitable - the whole concept will remain a straw house that people just drive straight through on their way to maintaining the fragile status quo. But this is the part they generally fail to calculate. To establish with certainty that this proposed body of tangled and very active subversion is an added and unnecessary event, rather than a true or necessary part of who we are, we will only need to be able to securely remove it. At the very first moment where that possibility becomes reliably repeatable, the theory that both predicted and enabled that transition will immediately become the proverbial brick house. And at that point anyone who had previously been casually driving straight through it will suddenly encounter a completely different situation. It will then be impossible to deny; it will suddenly

be like having this octopus in a bucket – it will have nowhere to hide, and its full anatomy will be exposed for everyone to see.

We have imagined it is who we are, but actually, it is just a parasite, a stowaway, an imposter. But the moment we see the reliable ability to isolate and remove it, our entire view of natural human experience shifts.

The implications are profound. It means the life you currently live, in whatever state you presently enjoy or suffer, is not your true, intrinsic potential. That is just a dim and tortured reflection, so much so that you can no longer even remember what that original state might feel like. This is part of the event itself: it robs us of heaven to make hell more bearable. We become numb, diminished, subtly compromised in ways difficult to perceive. And it is only natural that culture will come to accommodate this individual state, doing everything it can to make us as comfortable as possible under the circumstances. It is only trying to help in a sense, in just the same way as the originating event is paradoxically trying to help us, but the result at the end of the day is that in a bent world, bent people will appear straight, once again causing even more disorientation.

And this is everyone. There are no exceptions. This then becomes our baseline expectation for life, and we rarely imagine it could be otherwise.

In a sense it is a kind of prison, an existential bind so complete and profound that we no longer remember what freedom is, or even that it exists. And as indicated, this upside-down situation also means that those with the least intellectual integrity, or who are most willing to compromise their own internal reality, will often rise to the top. They can more easily dislocate their "imagined reality" from the real world, letting it run wild. They simply decorate their prison cell from within a state of resigned surrender, and as a result will often suffer less than those who are still bravely seeking to escape from it.

So, what is the uncomfortable truth we are all avoiding? For the most part, this avoidance is itself the thing being avoided. We deny the denial, and turn away from the fact that we are so powerfully turning away at every moment. We live in a kind of stimulated trance, and the world has come to reflect this impulse, and to support it at every point. And what this means is that the only thing we really need to be looking at is the one thing we can never openly face: that what we see in every person today is, in all its various forms, the same twisted and distorted state. And we don't even know it.

That's the whole point of how it works. If we did know, especially collectively, we would have undone this centuries ago. But the nature of this avoidance also means that profound honesty is required, and therefore that not everyone will be capable of exploring the territory all of this implies, at least not at first. And this begins to indicate who we might be speaking to here, especially during the very early stages.

On screen: The Wright Brothers Moment: A Tipping Point for Humanity

With this basic foundation down, we can now begin to examine the practical import of this emerging theory, and the possibility of undoing this great knot once and for all.

If it is possible, why haven't we seen it? But perhaps we have.

Consider for a moment: from this state of cultural and psychological captivity, where we don't even realize this event is occurring within us, how would such a "release event" in any single individual be perceived from a distance?

Conversely, what would it feel like from the inside? Think of the computer analogy again: what does a computer look like after a virus has been removed? It has less going on, right? Yet it works far better, as designed. But what would it look like from the perspective of another infected computer, if that computer didn't know it was infected? It would look like the "liberated" computer suddenly got some kind of "miraculous" upgrade.

Therefore, in a world where essentially 100% of people have this subversive event, what would it mean for one person to find release? Could that added event simply fall away? Do we even see this occasionally? I think we actually do. And here's the connection to an entirely different field: this "falling away" event is almost certainly what has been historically called "awakening," "self-realization," or "spiritual enlightenment." But if so, and if they really are the same thing, then it has certainly been dramatically misrepresented. Which is not to say that anyone has been intentionally disingenuous, but that we may have been viewing the whole thing backwards, and also that this misconception may have been the reason we never see any reliable repetition.

Most people who find this release apparently weren't even looking for it - they didn't understand the "virus" when they had it, and therefore don't truly understand its absence now that it has gone. And this is probably why so-called "enlightened masters" so rarely produce "enlightened devotees," even though what they themselves have found may be entirely real. It's just not what they think it is, based only on what it feels like from the inside out.

So, what does this anatomy deliver? It immediately draws a previously unnoticed connection -

Imagine two storyboards:

- On one, Becker and the common person: a deep problem identified, but no functional anatomy, no indication of its extrinsic nature, and therefore no means to address it.
- On the other, the "awakened masters": they have the answer, but it's an empty cage. They can't define what was there, and can't reliably reproduce that absence in others. They only know this release exists, they know the simplicity that remains, but not the complexity that was removed. But for someone "seeking" such radical potential, knowing a hamburger exists doesn't really help - that only makes them more hungry, not less.

This is the big reveal here: They are the same thing. The existential crisis at the heart of Becker's work is absolutely identical to what is missing in anyone "awakened." The symmetry is perfectly aligned, just reversed. One is simply the absence of the other.

We've been viewing this whole situation upside down from within our state of collective blindness. We simply didn't know we were all in artificial bondage, so we had no way to understand what might be occurring when someone has this dilemma spontaneously released.

These rare individuals appear elevated, sublime, superhuman. But we fail to consider that it's not they who were elevated, but we who have been debased, artificially lowered from our natural birthright. It is we who are stuck. The alarms are sounding, and we are fleeing the building in fear, but the fire isn't even real. It's only the panic causing the trouble. But we don't know this, so we never think to just calmly wander back in and look for the alarm switch, and turn it off.

So where is that switch? This emerging anatomy makes that very clear. You won't even need to be told. The moment you see how it works, you'll know exactly where it is.

This is what the emerging anatomy defines - there really is a single switch that turns this whole problem off, once and for all.

It might not be easy to find that originating spark without a very good map, but once you do find it, the entire thing essentially pops like a balloon, and never comes back again.

This is another thing we see with these so-called 'awakened' individuals. Whatever that may turn out to be, this feature is totally unambiguous - they never revert to their previous state. Not ever. It is a one way deal. But now we see why - it is because it is not a developmental shift, like the climbing of a mountain that you could somehow fall off, but rather a collapse of sorts.

The individual shift we are indicating does not represent an 'achievement' in the sense we would normally understand such - as being any kind of advanced stage associated with 'higher development'. It is not the summit of any psychological mountain. It is actually more akin to a landslide in this sense, a lowering of complexity, and a release of tension - a downward event in terms of universal entropy. It can happen from any stage of development. And what this means is that it is not only available to anyone, at any stage of development, but that it also has a one way arrow of time, in the same sense that you can't ever put an avalanche back up the mountain again.

This is the inversion here, the important shift in perspective the anatomy delivers: What you get is nothing. You don't become more. It's an absence. It doesn't make you special; it merely restores you to being normal again. And yet it's very real, and the shift is very dramatic.

The ongoing damage from this added event is enormous, far greater than you might imagine. So its removal actually offers the greatest potential for positive transformation available to us, by quite some margin. Nothing else comes close. Even becoming a billionaire wouldn't come close to this, and it might soon be available to everyone, for free.

Imagine what it would mean for such a potential to exist. Is that not what we have been waiting for?

Conversely, imagine that if we don't fix this, that nothing will ever be okay - not AI, not free energy, not even aliens arriving to save the day. The issue is deep within us, not out there in the world. It is upstream from the collective, in the heart of the individual. And what this means is that if you simply throw more energy at it, you will only amplify the problem, rather than resolve it. Nothing will ever be fixed in that case, because you carry this submerged dilemma with you everywhere you go.

For instance - and as we already intimated here - AI is only power. Like money it is only an amplifier. It has no intrinsic polarity. It is only a deeper reflection of who we already are. So we all seem to be wondering whether AI will ultimately be evil and seek to destroy us. But the real question is about us, and whether or not it is we who are evil.

There are many deep lessons here in this sense, many imports that we don't have time to get into at this early stage. But needless to say, all of this has some profound philosophical implications in relation to where the actual baseline is for humanity.

It's a terrifying possibility: a world where every person suffers from this affliction, which no wealth or prosperity can solve. It would mean everyone is barking up the wrong tree. Money is only an amplifier in this sense; it might even make this worse. Even technologies like AI will only exacerbate this fundamental issue, rather than solve it.

Ultimately, it's a problem resolvable only upstream, at its origin, deep in the individual human unconscious. But if true, then it's also the most incredibly positive insight ever discovered. The anatomy points to a basic functional reality, a clear path to a kind of 'existential release' that has been entirely out of view. We haven't seen it collectively because we can't see it individually. And at the

individual level we can't see the solution because we can't see the problem. We won't even look, and even if we do, we will generally fail to see. Its very function is to make people blind to itself.

On the face of things it is a very dark picture. And yet, this collective blindness is fragile, which is where we see the power. This is our exit. When that membrane pops, it will be gone in a flash. It will burst like a bubble. It won't even be that difficult. We just didn't know it was there.

So yes, it seems dark. But two things redeem this situation. Firstly, that it will only take a daring few to take a closer look and begin to extract reliable applications from all this theory. And secondly just that very fact - that this theory implies a very clear practice.

It is an empirically falsifiable claim, and therefore has proof associated. It points to a specific latent potential in every person, and that potential is not just an idea; it is a structural and functionally embedded fact. And the theoretical foundation here not only makes this prediction, but also very clearly points to a path by which that outcome might be practically achieved.

Therefore, it is inevitable that such a claim – based on such a provocative foundation – might initially be met with denial and derision. It will be ignored and dismissed, and perhaps even deeply feared.

In this case, however, it is also implied that it will only take a brave few to venture forth toward the obvious applications indicated, and that the moment this release potential is established in practice, in any repeatable sense, we will have hit an explosive threshold. There will then be no going back, and no amount of denial will ever again silence the truth. As Eddington did for Einstein, the cat will then be very securely out of the bag, once and for all.

Just as with the Wright brothers and aviation, the resulting development will be completely unstoppable from the moment that initial practical threshold is crossed in a way that can be reliably repeated by any third party. And downstream will be a spiraling cascade, a tsunami of collective transformation.

This is what people always get wrong at first. Most commonly they will imagine it is just some kind of philosophical consideration, or a new psychological model. But while both of those things might be true from a certain angle, that's not really the best way to see this.

It is not just a new way of seeing things, not a new frame for the same old picture. It is far more dramatic than that. The 'release' event being indicated is an energetic and functional reality, not any kind of belief system. It is a singular and permanent shift in state, extremely stable in nature - not any kind of effort based practice that needs to be maintained over time.

It is also a potential that could certainly be made reliably accessible to all people based on sufficient collective exploration and development, and here we see the first indications of its true magnitude. It points to the beginnings of a cascade of transformation that would leave the entire world changed in ways we didn't even know were possible. And this is where we need to jump out to examine the power of culture in this context, if only to begin making sense of the truly epic scale of what is being proposed.

In the individual we see the possibility of a structural and energetic shift, a very particular maneuver that has the effect of taking down this entire subversive agenda at its root.

It is immediately quite confusing for various reasons, and as a result people will often mistake it for things it is not. From the position of subjective conscious experience that potential represents a shift so profound that it is almost impossible to explain to anyone beforehand in any meaningful sense. It is

literally inconceivable for most people, and this is not an accident. But what that does result in is a situation where we really can't see the way out, or even that something dramatically better might be available to us.

The nature of this individual transition is quite extreme, but not really that complicated overall - it is just something that cannot easily be managed by the person undergoing that transformation, and therefore requires a degree of external support. We can't even see it without this external support, if only because that's how it works. It's the one thing we can't know about ourselves, but also the only really important thing there is to know. And this is where we have been stuck - the complete absence of collective awareness in this regard has left us individually stranded in this sense, unable to individually access a truly staggering potential that is actually resting easily within collective reach.

Therefore, what we see here is the entire individual puzzle being transferred to the collective level in order to find a broader solution to what now becomes a more cultural problem. There are many frameworks that offer a new way to see things, but people aren't really looking for a new way to understand the same old life. What they really want is a whole new life, and that's what this is proposing. The depth of this shift is profound, and it doesn't only happen in your head. Once you see how it works, and the scale of what is removed in that event, what it amounts to is a bodily transition to another state of being.

The point being - we see a situation where just the right stimulation at the collective level might lead to a cascading wave of release at an individual level, ending up in a far more stable state once that great transformation has run its course.

We therefore see two different views of the same event, depending on which group you belong to - the givers or the receivers. And once again we see the Wright brothers analogy here, and how that fits. The process of development that began with that first demonstration of powered flight was a spiralling cascade of upward complexity and refinement, one that also demanded more and more from anyone directly involved at the giving end. At the outset you only needed to be able to build a bicycle in order to be included in that event, but these days you need six years of very specific engineering at university level in order to even begin work in the aerospace sector. And yet, for all that time, the opposite has been true at the receiving end - the same process of upward development for a few has made it easier and cheaper for the many to access the practical results of such dedicated efforts.

In this sense we see these two processes moving in opposite directions, and also involving a very different type of person. The essential hurdle in the individual centres around the high emotional stress associated with that transition, or just prior to it, along with the profound emotional disorientation involved. But both of those things can be dramatically mitigated by the presence of powerful external support, and this is why finding those few becomes the aim. It is all about establishing the particular cultural event that will eventually deliver that very targeted external intervention.

So we are basically speaking to two completely different groups here. It is implied. We also see two different timelines associated - the immediate short term costs, and then the far greater long term gains.

For most people, in the downstream sense, it will simply arrive and wash over them like a towering wave. They won't need to know how it all works, any more than they know how an airliner works. It will simply work because a few really smart people will have figured it all out for them. It will just deliver the whole package, making it fully accessible, at first for a price no doubt, but increasingly cheaply, and eventually for free. But all of that will only occur because a few really smart people got hold of

what was only a very rough map at first, but then got together to explore that territory in greater detail, and eventually opened up a pathway that everyone could follow.

This was the primary thing - we needed the information. We needed this anatomy, so as to be able to tell these two events apart. So the essential transition we see at the collective level does not involve tension so much as blindness.

This is how the two stable states are expressed slightly differently at the collective level, in that what we see in that broader context is more like the bursting of a dam. We see the possibility of this spiralling process of exploration and development, which will then lead to the great cascading wave of release implied, but that we are not even aware that the whole thing exists. Which means that the only thing preventing that now is a lack of awareness that this other stable state is even possible in the individual, along with how that might be made reliably accessible in practice. At that level it will only take one tiny hole for the entire thing to begin to unravel, at which point it will immediately become unstoppable.

It is a strange and unusual situation, where quite a simple but very powerful shift in the individual has been prevented by an equally pernicious and very stubborn blindness in the same individual.

That is simply how this particular affliction works. Nobody has trapped us, we are doing it to ourselves. But the solution is also just as simple in essence - just to have the courage to look, and especially to do that together.

We really only need to have this anatomical framework established, so as to be able to orient and inform any practice in a way that is suddenly able to achieve the stable release of this entire subversive event in the individual, right at its very root, once and for all. And that is something only the collective will achieve.

On screen: The Cure: 2EQ and The Path Home

Up until this point we have been speeding along through this territory, and skipping over many important details in order to be brief, but our language will need to change a bit at this stage as we switch down to a lower gear and begin to get deeper into the mud. We need to start zooming in now, as we reach the point where all of this remains stuck. The whole thing is currently approaching an explosive threshold, and for all we know by the time you see this that point may already have been crossed.

So how does it work, this process of relinquishment? What have people got wrong about it? And what difference does this anatomy make, in light of its ability to functionally separate these two events? Why would that matter so much?

Imagine a tumor – an added growth causing great discomfort. If it were cancer, chemotherapy or radiation would isolate it from healthy tissue by first of all understanding what makes it different – its reproductive cycle. You wouldn't even need to know more than that.

This is the power of critical understanding. We would simply stop everything, and apply pressure for longer than cancer can last, but shorter than healthy tissue can survive, thereby differentiating and eliminating the pathology.

The same basic principle applies to this ubiquitous, subversive event. Transposing this mechanism to a mental context gives us a clear picture: "suspending everything" means stopping the activity of both systems in a very particular sense, and using very specific tools, each depending on the various symptoms being addressed at any point.

That is why we see this as the ultimate aim of all meditative practices: stop the mind. But most apply that injunction incorrectly if the aim is to have a lasting effect on this underlying dilemma. Which it is, of course. The overt and explicit aim of almost all such traditions is 'spiritual enlightenment.' And here we see a bit of confusion not only about what these traditional approaches are seeking to achieve, but also how they are seeking to achieve it, which perhaps accounts for the staggeringly low success rate associated. I mean how many people would show up at McDonalds if they only had about a one in ten thousand chance of actually getting a burger?

People clearly don't know enough about this potential in order to claim to be experts. That's what becomes immediately plain the moment you see what is really going on. A little bit of chemo doesn't cure cancer; it might even make it worse. And too much will kill the patient.

It's all going to sound very disrespectful. For some people it might even seem like sacrilege to be presuming to wander into such 'spiritual' territory using a broadly scientific worldview, but why should any such aspects of human potential be somehow exempt from practical understanding? As with so many previously mysterious parts of life, all of those stories are just what it looks like prior to a more solid map emerging. And this will be no different. The Black Death was a great mystery at the time, but now even a child can use a microscope and spot the culprit.

The key in this case is in understanding the precise aim in this context, and in using the tools according to the outcomes being sought.

Used correctly, meditation – or any practice associated with this critical transition to freedom – is not a remedy, it is a cure. And as such, if applied in the right way, any particular tool need only be used once, and then discarded forever. Not that the resulting stillness disappears, but the necessity of any tool to achieve such vanishes. The stillness people seek in meditation becomes the permanent default once the free state is found, and all practices suddenly fall away as being obsolete at that point. So if you are seeking to remove this event entirely, which of course you are, then a little meditation is worthless. It might even be worse than nothing - like jumping a ditch, but with not enough impetus to reach the other side. Splash! And that is the mud so many spiritual seekers find themselves in.

What you really need is to stop the mind – just once. Truly stop it. But here is the important thing: not only the mind. This is the critical connection here. In many ways the mind might be least important of all, with all the truly powerful anchors being far more energetic in nature, and in many cases physical.

This "metaphorical octopus" has many limbs, some of them deeply visceral. And you need to know them all, their impact on the event's purpose and metabolism, and apply enough pressure to all of them at once to push the center of gravity of the whole edifice across the defining collapse threshold – and all without damaging healthy functions.

There's no point attempting a rescue if you only end up shooting the hostage in the process. This is another mistake we see, one of many. It's possible to fall short, that's most common, but it's also possible to cut too deeply. It is all a result of not clearly differentiating these two events.

The Buddha said all suffering comes from attachment – but no attachment at all also makes you a vegetable. So you need to be able to tell the healthy system from the disease, and adopt an approach that removes only the problematic parts. And all current practices fall short in this regard. There are no

exceptions. None of them clearly differentiate these two events in any reliably practical way, and the results of that failure speak for themselves.

So you can dress up like a guru, or write a hundred books on meditation, but if this seminal release is possible, and if you are not actually producing that summary relinquishment in people on a very reliable basis, then you are missing the only mark that matters. That might even be setting us all back by falsely claiming to represent something you don't actually offer.

It's simply not that easy, not without the critical anatomy to guide you. The situation is very stable and extremely fluid. This octopus is slippery, and if you leave even the smallest hole, it will always just slither out of your net again. And even if someone does manage to corner it, most people still won't push it far enough to achieve this lasting release. That remains very rare indeed. But flying was not only rare but completely unheard of prior to 1903, and yet look at the world today. Being uncommon does not make something impossible. It doesn't even make something particularly difficult. It might just mean you need to know how, and that it doesn't tend to happen by accident.

For this dynamic entrapment, along with how to get out of it, we use the analogy of a ball in a bowl -

In the common state, the situation is free in a sense but also fundamentally captured, like an orange rolling around in a fruit bowl. You can push it up the sides of the bowl with effort, but the moment you let go it will always just roll back down to the middle again – which in this case is a distorted point of stable dis-equilibrium.

Even if any intentional practice manages to push it in exactly the right direction, it will eventually just make its way back to that point again. And this often leads to emotional fatigue and disillusionment. People start to see themselves as 'spiritual failures', when actually their chosen explanation simply lacks a complete map of the territory.

All such practices are merely a means, not an end. And in almost all cases, the true and only end has not been clearly enough defined.

So what is that true mark? What is the tipping threshold? Defining this release is the point of the emerging paradigm here. It is all about understanding this singular moment of transition. That is the threshold between these two stable states, where you are literally entering a completely different equilibrium. And it is also the transition from one world to another entirely different world. We just can't see this entire 'other bowl' from our trapped position in the common state. We wouldn't even know which direction to move, or how such movement might be generated, not at all the different levels required to affect this vast and dynamic rolling ball at its true center of gravity.

So, which practice is good? All are good, and all are worthless, depending on use and context. We already have everything we need by far, an embarrassment of riches in that sense.

People have been climbing all over this great twisted knot for millennia, mapping out all of its various elements in great detail, as well as developing many practical interventions. Some of those are even quite powerful. But we currently lack the critical insight necessary to put this 'transformation engine' together correctly. We lack the unifying perspective required to bring people together with a common purpose, under a single paradigm.

Only the deeper framework of understanding matters in this context, and that has been entirely missing. The ability to differentiate these two events is critical, and for that, the anatomy is required.

This is the power of the emerging model - it is the ability to define this peak of tension, the exact threshold that signifies this shift from one bowl to another, representing final freedom from this

seemingly eternal trap. It means there really is a moment, a line you can cross, that will leave you fundamentally in a different state of being – and that this shift is permanent.

This is the central tenet of the emerging paradigm. At a foundational level it separates these two events. But what that actually points to, if one of those really can be removed and undone, is that for every individual person there are actually two stable states available, rather than just the twisted and distorted one we currently know. There are actually Two Equilibriums available to us, hence: 2EQ.

This is the key thing to know. Another entire bowl exists, separated by a peak of high tension. And you can traverse that stressful threshold if you know how, especially with the right type of support. This may not be easy for an individual to achieve alone, any more than you can easily perform surgery on yourself. But collectively, and in just the same way, it could be made accessible to everyone over time. We would only need a deep enough understanding, and for that insight to be widely enough shared with the right people, at the right level.

Making that reliably accessible to all people is a team game by definition. And at this point we begin to see not only the impact of the individual crisis on that shape of society as a whole, but also - and especially - the way culture tends to shape the individual.

The idea we have been using of the ball rolling around in a bowl is a very simplistic representation of our dynamically trapped state, but it is also important to clearly distinguish the individual level from the collective in this sense, especially given how dramatically these two levels impact each other.

The same conflicted dynamic we see in the individual is naturally reflected in broader society and culture, in just the same way that a million polluted tributaries will inevitably produce a polluted river. And likewise with this transition to freedom in the individual, we also see that same pattern expressed in the collective due to the way that potential will inevitably become available everywhere, and pretty much all at once.

So just as we see that there are actually two stable states available for any individual, we also see the same pattern reflected at the collective level. We see the same kind of peak of tension in between, except that it is expressed slightly differently in that context.

At the individual level we see a somewhat tense and turbulent process that - with the right support - will ultimately lead to a summary relinquishment, a simplifying and cleansing collapse of this entire body of subversive activity in the unconscious. And for most people this will require no prior knowledge or development. It will simply arrive like the rising of the sun, based on the efforts of a small and dedicated few who have done all of that work for them.

We might call this the retail level. But at what we might call the wholesale level, where just a few get together to generate this small bounded event, we see quite the opposite - with a kind of feeding frenzy that will be kicked off the moment awareness becomes available in the right terms. In that context we see a very high degree of understanding and awareness being implemented and embodied in the development of practical applications that are first of all able to stimulate this release in the individual, but that are then also capable of correctly interpreting and explaining the resulting state within a balanced and rational theoretical framework.

Wow, that sounds complicated! And yes, it might be. But for anyone particularly suited to this sort of territory all of that will be a walk in the park. So that's who we are talking to here ultimately.

This is the central import of the view - that it is very receptive to group power and insight. But only at a certain level, and there are clearly some challenges in relation to merely sharing this idea, given how

threatening that might be for many people. And this explains where the entirety of human civilization has been stuck for all this time.

The absence of this anatomy has left us trapped in the common bowl, forever restless, and never finding escape. Many so-called 'spiritual' practices aim correctly in a narrow or isolated sense, usually targeting just a single limb of this octopus, but are rarely applied with sufficient insight or resolve in the right direction, or in the right combinations, to achieve a stable transition across the only threshold that really matters here. And without that, they offer little more virtuous than any other typical experience within the common state. A yoga retreat is not 'higher' than a week-long party in Ibiza in this sense. That sort of claim would just be self-righteous ego. That's like two junk dealers arguing about who has the best junk.

The common state is the common state. From this perspective it's all basically the same thing in a million different forms. This is simply the natural consequence of something so bright coming so clearly into view - suddenly everything else becomes dark by contrast.

There really is only one fundamental path to freedom here, as defined by the nature of the trap, and failing to climb the prison wall is not a worthy hobby. That only gets you punished by the confused unconscious mind. Ignorance is not bliss in this sense. Context is everything.

Only insight is power. Only freedom is freedom. There is a far deeper and more permanent release available in this situation, and only practices that sustainably reach that liberated state are truly valuable if that's what you seek. Which it is, of course, regardless of whether or not you know it. This release is what everyone in this bind is ultimately seeking, even if they don't realise it yet.

So this is all of us. There is only one way out. Although that exit is also the one thing we generally have no way to clearly define, let alone to achieve in any reliable way. For the most part we simply yearn blindly, or numb our hunger using all manner of stimulation or addiction, but without the very fierce mirror to provide this essential differentiation - as well as at least a few people brave and honest enough to look - we will remain forever trapped. The biggest thing ever really is just sitting there right in front of us in a sense, and it's not even that we are struggling to solve that puzzle in any meaningful way. It's far worse than that. Solving it would be easy. The real problem is that nobody is even working on it, because nobody knows it is there.

Even when you point to it, people won't be able to look. And even if they look, they won't be able to see. And even if they see, they will refuse to understand. And even if they understand, they won't act. It is almost as if we are all suffering from some very active and targeted form of brain damage - an ongoing process of functional subversion that specifically targets the very thing we are seeking to explain. But of course, this is exactly what we are saying. So a strong negative response can be expected.

The only question now is - what can we actually do about it? And where do we go from here?

On screen: Capture, Qualification, and Conversation: The Path Forward

We are starting to see here how we might have got into this mess, but how can we get out of it?

The nature and location of what this insight brings to light provides a completely different picture of the typical human life, in that it points to the possibility that quite a large section of common motivation and experience is not actually intrinsic to us. It almost sounds trivial at first glance, but actually this

sets the foundations of an entirely different view of human life - reframing not only where we have come from, and where we are now, but also very dramatically adjusting our view of where we might go from here.

But perhaps you can begin to see the big issue here already, and also where the whole thing was hidden. We have a truly overwhelming imperative coming into view, but it is also something that most people simply can't see, or won't even look at. That's precisely how it works. So we feel the pain, but the origin remains a mystery. We are forever left to look outward in order to solve what is actually an internal problem. It's just that the true solution requires awareness and understanding of the true problem, and the problem in this case is busy concealing itself.

This is the situation we have been trapped in - so many of our problems ultimately resolve back to this single root cause, but that cause is invisible to us, so we have remained stuck.

In the end it all points to a remarkable way out of this whole mess, but it also explains exactly why nobody had previously noticed that exit. It was all hidden in the one place nobody would ever think to look - directly beneath our deepest possible fears.

This is the world we see today - endlessly conflicted and confused, steeped in deep underlying suffering within every individual, but also saturated in pervasive avoidance and denial. It is a situation that also meant this information was very difficult to come by in the first place, not only because of this deep aversion in the psychology of every individual, but also because all mention of this subject is being just as deeply eroded at a cultural level. It is being relentlessly washed away in every moment, so that any insight gained today would always be gone again by tomorrow.

As indicated already, the only obvious exception to this rule is Becker, who alone put a pin down on the map in exactly the right spot, but apparently without really grasping the full extent of what was buried there. And perhaps Heidegger before him. Then Terror Management Theory put a pin down right on top of those guys. But in each case only the problem was being pointed at, and with only half the picture, the same fate has befallen all of them; nothing sticks within a mile of this point. Like some kind of sociological Chernobyl, it is scorched earth in every direction around this 'ground zero' - an existential dead zone littered with the bones of many brave explorers. And yet, their aim was true in each case, and exactly right. In the future these people will be seen as the great heroes. They will all be vindicated in due course, as their intuitions are confirmed in ways they probably never imagined possible, as we now place another big pin right down on top of the whole bunch. It's just a shame those guys didn't quite penetrate deeply enough to hit the motherload that lies beneath - or see that there was light within that darkness.

The real treasure remains untouched and unclaimed, nobody is even digging in the right spot these days, at least not deeply enough to matter. In any case such victories are rare, and rarely celebrated. Common culture essentially has no memory for this, and our own unconscious is forever whitewashing this big dark issue at the core of life. That was our prison - a prison for the mind. All of which meant that no incremental development would naturally occur in this direction. Which in turn meant that - even though it lies within easy collective reach - this great unfolding cascade would also never be initiated under current circumstances, or even that it may never have been noticed at all. It could easily have remained hidden for a few more centuries yet.

The problem, essentially, is that what we are explaining here is true. The functional anatomy associated defines this activity as being sprawling and dynamic in nature, and able to take many possible forms, which has once again added to our failure to clearly differentiate it from our natural underlying pattern. But the main reason we have failed to see it is because concealment is the whole

reason this activity exists. It makes people very deeply afraid, it turns their gaze away from itself, and it also erodes cognitive faculties - as many as it needs to undermine in order to maintain this stable concealment.

It basically makes people weak, passive, and stupid. And yes, that obviously sounds terrible. And really, it is. Very few people appear to have remained relatively immune to this affliction in the areas that matter if ever we are going to exit this bind, and even those few will tend to be torn apart by common culture as a result of holding onto these rare traits. It is a bizarre situation, and in many ways completely unique.

Fortunately, and as we say, only a few will be required to embark on this deeper exploration in the first instance, thereby opening up the whole thing for everyone, and defining who those people are is another thing we will need to examine. That might even be the key to the whole event.

So what can we tell you, based on many years of experience? What secrets can we share?

For many years all of this remained stuck, deadlocked in a sense, bogged down in invisible quicksand due to several important facts being overlooked. Three main lessons were eventually learned, and these now set the stage for everything that will follow.

The first of these things is that the psychological shock associated with embracing this particular body of awareness for the first time is only a temporary effect, and that it really only seems to be coupled with the rather fragile blindness being indicated. It turns out that there is a certain tipping threshold here, as you make your way into it. And you may even be approaching that yourself as you listen to this. There is a kind of critical mass that can be reached here, a tipping point in a sense, as awareness begins to penetrate what was previously withheld from conscious view. And beyond that point we can see a falling away of a kind of veil that had previously kept the whole thing out of view - and with that we also see aversion being suddenly outweighed by interest in some sense, so that insight begins to conquer fear. Overall, beyond a certain penetration, there is a kind of direct transcendence associated.

So what we see in this transition is the beginnings of a kind of chain reaction, where the conscious mind is essentially starting to excavate space for itself. Overall, it can feel like a child who has managed to break into new wings of a mansion that had previously been boarded up as being off limits - a bit scary at first, but also very exciting!

It turns out that the unconscious mind is very pragmatic in this sense, and will not waste time maintaining any pretense if the game is basically up. So when you catch it out in this lie, in light of the anatomy we are indicating becoming clear enough, it will eventually just admit defeat. Suddenly it will let you in, and allow you to take a look around. It will simply let a great deal of that effort go.

But just to clarify, we are not speaking about releasing the deep subversive event as a whole in this sense. That is a much deeper possibility. We are only talking about the resulting surface level blindness, along with a great deal of the loaded aversion associated. Just one very thin but important surface layer.

The point being - from that time forward it all starts to make sense, with interest now outweighing aversion for the first time due to having essentially transcended the blindness associated. Something is still being covered up, but now you can see that it is being covered up, and also how. The balloon of

concealment has essentially popped at that point, and suddenly what was only confusing and scary now becomes fascinating and fun, perhaps even familiar.

This is what the emerging map does. And this effect is especially powerful when shared, as when any group of people get together to explore this territory in conversation.

The key thing here is that this loaded emotional aversion can be inverted and overthrown. And the overall effect of that is always quite clear - the previous situation was one where there was a tendency to roll away from such awareness, which is now replaced by an impulse just as powerful in the other direction. You now roll towards it without even trying. What was previously the worst thing imaginable suddenly becomes the best thing ever. And with that, the philosophical gates are finally opened. Everything suddenly starts to fall into place just naturally once the artificial barriers are let go and released.

We have come to call this tipping point 'capture.' It is perhaps a bit like the moment when you are piecing together a jigsaw puzzle without knowing what it is a picture of - and you place down just one more piece and suddenly you realise what it all means. You finally see the whole picture for the first time, in a flash of insight, even though nothing much will have changed, and the puzzle might still not be entirely complete. But you basically get it.

The important lesson here was that without this elementary shift right at the start, the entire thing will inevitably just bounce off any normal person's heavily loaded emotional armour. They simply won't bother with continuing to work away on the puzzle. So if that is not done, right at the start, then you would basically be wasting your time in seeking to move forward into any deeper exploration. It just won't make sense for them, and the whole story will fall into space so to speak.

Actually it can be terrible for people to waste their time and energy by going too deeply into all of this without first of all grasping the basic outlines, because without that none of it will be unpacked correctly, or arranged in the right way. And what this means is that even the large books will make little sense in the first instance, even to someone very intelligent, not if this basic point of clarity has not been securely reached right at the start. And this is something we have now established with some degree of certainty.

So that is the first thing: Capture is primary.

This sets the stage. That is first base so to speak.

The second thing we came to understand is that this 'octopus' is very slippery, and that if all you ever do is just listen passively to a few talks like this, then you will generally not be moving fast enough to catch it, not in the particular form that is unique to you. So this capture moment will never occur. And here we see the power of dialogue.

In conversation, this point of capture appears to be reached many times faster, and more dynamically, which perhaps explains why the unconscious has so powerfully sought to ban all open cultural exchange in this direction. But especially in dialogue with anyone who already knows this event very well, all of that backward force disappears. It is canceled out, and suddenly you are kicking this added event all around the room like a football. Pretty soon you can not only get hold of it for yourself, but also help others to do the same.

This process of two-way exchange should not be underestimated. For the most part being in our little conscious fish tank of a mind with this big unconscious octopus can be quite serene - but only if it remains asleep, and isn't hungry. But the moment you begin to provoke it in this way, suddenly it's not quite so friendly. Suddenly it's like being in a cage with a lion - so having a lion tamer present can be quite a relief, especially during those initial stages.

Conversation is power in this context. And this is why we have started answering questions directly on the forum associated, for anyone prepared to ask. Merely reading about it in any passive way simply doesn't have the same effect. But the moment you have some kind of rebound happening, and especially if you know what it is trying to hide, suddenly the octopus can no longer keep up.

So that is the second thing: Conversation is penetration.

This gives us power. And perhaps you can see how these two insights arrived together in a sense. The possibility of capture only became clear once we began to talk about all of this more openly, which for many years was not seen as a realistic option.

The general unconscious hostility most people exhibit in relation to this subject matter meant that working away in isolation had become the main path, with direct conversation being avoided where possible. It just didn't seem fruitful. Indeed, it was downright tortuous. But now we see why - it was because this important threshold had never been achieved for people right at the start, thereby failing to open the way for the true and natural conversation to begin. People who might otherwise have discovered a great passion for it were left in an 'unhatched' state, like a chick still stuck inside the shell - a hardened and enclosed situation where habitual resistance still dominated. So it was a kind of catch 22. But the moment this combination became clear, suddenly the floodgates opened so to speak, with direct conversation then not only becoming possible, but was then seen as the preferred path forward. A deep puzzle appeared to have been solved.

This brings us to the third key thing, which is something that could never have become clear until the other two had been found. Conversation achieves capture in pretty much anyone now that we have the basic anatomy sketched out, and also on an extremely reliable basis, but that combination wasn't enough.

It wasn't as if conversation and capture were worthless in this sense, but that they are only half of the picture. Aiming the gun and pulling the trigger aren't enough - first you need to load it. And it turns out that interest and ability are two completely different things in this context. Anyone might be interested in rockets, but that doesn't necessarily make you a rocket scientist, as every kid eventually figures out. And in this situation what that means is that while the important moral fire might be lit in pretty much anyone merely by chatting away, that this will not necessarily empower them in any meaningful sense. Anyone might then understand what's at stake, but due to the particular nature of the problem - and the demands associated with the solution - many still won't be able to do much about it.

Basically, the territory itself requires a certain set of abilities, especially in the early stages, and the beginning is the only part that really matters in this situation. Everything downstream from there will be completely automatic, and available to everyone equally. But none of that will occur if we can't first of all isolate these few rare people who happened to embody the particular characteristics that might set them apart in this sense.

And here we see our third big lesson coming into view: Qualification is crucial.

In a nutshell, what became clear is that what we see emerging here is probably a full blown field of science, in many ways as deep as physics or microbiology, or perhaps even deeper. After all, the human brain is the single most complicated structure ever discovered, and what we are examining here is an even more complicated subversion of that system.

You might even be forgiven for thinking that I am just describing psychology here. But no, not really. If this turns out to be broadly correct then what we call psychology today, in all of its various forms, would appear to have overlooked the only truly important fact about how the typical human mind actually works. Which is obviously rather embarrassing, especially when you consider how elementary the model is that separates these two events. So we certainly can't expect too much open support from that direction, at least not at first, if only because such a glaring omission defines so much of that work as being both facile and inane. With the only obvious exceptions to this being the ones we have already mentioned.

Basically, to speak about human psychology without speaking first and foremost about separating out this added subversive event - what it is, where it came from, how it works - is pretty much to demonstrate that you really don't know even the very first thing about that subject. It really is difficult to sugar coat this claim without losing the core insight in the process. It is simply unavoidable. But this is just what it means to be part of a culture that has made such a deep mistake - it's like being caught with your philosophical pants down. But I suppose this is a story only time will tell.

In any case, it is a deep and complicated subject. And what this means is that while we may be able to explain it all in relatively simplistic terms, for a relatively general audience, by the time you are looking at applying all of this in practice it's always only going to be open to a much rarer and far more capable few. It might even be a domain that requires a few years of high level education to lay the foundations associated, just as we see in every other field of science. That would be quite normal in the wake of an insight this deep.

All of which means we are left to seek out a very particular type of person, and to provide them with whatever information they will require, and also in terms best suited to them.

Regardless, and however it might be gained, this functional differentiation delivers immense power - especially in the right hands. Suddenly it becomes possible to figure out which way is up, and things become accessible that were previously out of reach.

In particular, and as this previously hidden target comes into view so clearly, collective alignment and broad unified action in this direction becomes possible for the first time ever.

This explains the power of the model – the essential missing piece. Separation of the two events is the key. The conscious mind cannot do this on its own, not within a context so dramatically erosive to the emergence of such insight; that is like trying to lift yourself up by your shoestrings. So we need a deeper framework, an external point of reference that our own unconscious cannot assault, like a mirror that is made of stainless steel, rather than glass, so as to stop our own unconscious from immediately throwing stones at it.

This functional separation might even be the final key to everything. We never figured it out before, it was the one thing we just couldn't ever see, so we had no power. But now we do, for anyone who can bear to look.

The ability to isolate these two events not only lowers emotional aversion over time, but also delivers more and more insight at every turn. The confused conscious self suddenly has a spade in its hand, and a clear indication of where to dig. So if what the map predicts is actually hidden right where it indicates, then nothing else is required. Individually, and especially collectively, it now becomes possible to solve this 'social blindness' problem once and for all. And with that power in enough hands - especially as a team - this process will eventually become explosive. It will be like a gold rush.

As indicated, this is why the unconscious mind will do everything in its power to prevent such dialogue from taking place, by relentlessly dissuading people from ever starting a simple conversation about it. And you will probably already be feeling the effects of this yourself at this point, as your own unconscious scrambles to push this big steaming lump back under the rug. It will be telling you in no uncertain terms that this is definitely not something you might ever want to talk about. But what might happen if we did? Think about what's at stake. Aren't you even slightly curious?

In the end it presents us with a few interesting dilemmas, and really only seems to offer us one way out. Ultimately, we need to shift our ability to acquire and maintain such awareness as a culture, thereby tipping this balance over time, and making the gradual accumulation of critical insight inevitable at a collective level. We basically need to open this new territory up for exploration. And for this we need only two things: a good enough map, and a bit of good company.

We would then only need to get together to penetrate the whole thing deeply enough to determine whether that map is actually correct. At which point we will either collectively debunk the central claim as being false - and thus walk away satisfied - or we will together confirm it as being true instead. In which case confidence will surge, as internal resistance falls away.

Either way we will no longer be afraid of it. What was scary in isolation will suddenly become exciting as a group, as the map is increasingly discovered to match the territory exactly, and especially as the broader implications start to come into view for everyone involved.

This is the balance we need to tip here now that the situation is becoming clear. We can begin to see where all of this has been hidden, but also what dragging it out into the light is going to cost. It is implied that not everyone will be ready for the path it indicates in the first instance, but it is also a situation where not everyone will need to even see it coming. It might even be better if many people don't.

On screen: Safety First: No Pushing in the Deep End

As we come to the end here, and as the dust begins to settle on something that must surely be starting to boggle your mind a little, we are left with some very big questions.

Firstly we begin to see the scale of the whole thing, and the depth - just the absurdity of what it all implies. Few people are able to immediately fathom the magnitude of what is being proposed, at least not at first, and in part this is probably because they don't really appreciate what it would mean for themselves personally. But it really isn't that difficult to grasp.

Think about it this way -

If everything we know and feel consciously is resting on the same essential bedrock - that being the emotional foundations of typical human behavior - then what would happen if that motivational landscape had somehow been seriously distorted in a very dynamic but stable way?

The Oxford English Dictionary defines happiness as being 'the fulfillment of desire'. And actually that's a pretty good summary when you break it down, at least from the perspective of conscious experience.

So consider a dark scenario - imagine a malicious entity that could randomly stimulate powerful, visceral desire within you. Real desire, not anything fake in any way, let's say the origin would be irrelevant from any conscious perspective. What could you do, especially if you were unaware of what was going on? What would that feel like?

Your own emotional foundations would have been randomly corrupted in that case, but what if there was no way to tell these two rivers apart once they had merged, and what if everything you saw around you also told you to "trust yourself," and "follow what you feel"? Life would then become an endless, agonizing loop. There would be no way to escape this bind. Even if the distortion in question was only tiny, it would nevertheless represent a permanent loss of happiness at that level, and to exactly that degree.

This is what the behavioral tendencies associated with this added event ultimately look like. The arbitrary generation of surplus desire is absolutely identical to the direct generation of unhappiness. They are essentially the same thing, because if the tendencies in question are both costly and do not represent legitimate healthy transactions, then you will either suffer physically from fulfilling them, or suffer emotionally from resisting them. And this is the typical life.

We therefore see a profound question emerging here once this underlying situation becomes clearer -

What if this is precisely what has occurred in our own case, but what if the offending disruption is not small at all - but a vast and dynamic and very stable body of subversive distortion? And what if the true conditions for boundless happiness - at a level far beyond what we generally experience - are actually already present, but simply not being experienced as such?

Basically, what if everything we have been looking for is already contained within just one of these motivational streams, and what if the other one is just the poisonous discharge from a proverbial chemical plant? And what if culture might soon be able to show us not only how to separate these two different flows, but perhaps even show us how to shut that toxic pain factory down forever, and then clean up all the mess?

What if we were able to do all of that in a way that anyone could access freely? It is a lot to take in. So perhaps we could recap what we have covered here, just to make sure we grasp the absurd gravity of what is being indicated, and what it all ultimately means -

- 1. Our psychological situation is defined by two distinct things, not just one as we generally imagine.
- 2. The second, added event, is far more serious than we might suspect, and is also universally present in all people, pretty much defining what it means these days to be 'normal.'

- 3. That body of unconscious activity is stable, dynamic, and very hard to get hold of, if only because its primary function is concealment.
- 4. However, and with enough information, even a moderate degree of collective development could initiate its removal in any individual.
- 5. The moment that begins to occur in single individuals on a reliable basis - because that will represent unequivocal proof for the claim - we will immediately see the beginnings of a process of development that will inevitably see this release possibility made available to all.
- 6. It would probably only take a handful of very well-informed people to initiate this cascade, with the results being both immediately unstoppable as well as completely irreversible.
- 7. On the other hand, the world will forever remain stuck if we don't manage to achieve this collective ignition by getting this information into the right hands, in the right terms.

The whole picture is so vast and dramatic that it is difficult to know how to view it. The world we see today appears to be quite stable, and people appear relatively happy overall. But actually neither of these things is true, and that is what this emerging view makes very clear. In reality, people are struggling far more than they will generally admit, and the world also stands teetering on the brink of the most dramatic single process of grassroots change in all of recorded history, in the form of this great hidden cascade.

The world is not stable at all. That collapse could be initiated at any moment. It all comes down to this tiny triggering event - just the right information being delivered to the right people in the right terms - with the results being the greatest single process of deep level change the world has ever seen. And once again, this is not a metaphor. It really is absurd. In such a brief space as this, there is realistically no way for me to impress on you just how extreme the whole prospect is.

What we are talking about here is the single greatest problem you have ever faced, by far - a problem you are still confronting today - for that to be resolved completely, and also in a way that will become accessible to all people before too long. It just can't be true - and yet it really might be.

It ultimately points not only to a different experience of the world from the inside out, but also a different world to experience from the outside in. But we can't see this solution for the world because we can't see the problem in ourselves. This is how it works. And so we remain stuck.

The claim is not ambiguous in any way. It all defines one very specific phenomenon: what we are calling this 'release event' in the individual. And this part is not really up for serious debate, in that we already see many instances of this in the world today. I could give you a long list of individuals who have quite clearly found this free state for themselves.

I'm quite sure Terror Management Theory could just as easily research and confirm the absence of this activity in these people if they wanted to, just as they have so resoundingly confirmed its presence in everyone else.

You would only need to meet one of these people to know for certain that it is not just some kind of delusional state. But here is the important part - I could not point to a single one of these 'liberated' individuals who has managed to stimulate that transition in others on any reliable basis. And the reason for this seems self-evident: they don't really know what it is. This is sad, but also undeniable once you see what is really going on.

Here we see the important leap we are making with the ability to differentiate these two events. That singular release possibility in every person represents the existence of a concealed gateway to a truly staggering shift in individual state. But it is also - and most critically - a potential that might become available to every person in due course, once it is sufficiently understood at a collective level.

This is the big news here. Not that this possibility exists. The Buddha showed us that much. And many others also. That part is not new. But it has also remained completely enigmatic due to the lack of adequate explanation. And people seem to simply accept that situation, as if that is normal. But no, that is actually just ignorance. The Buddha didn't actually know what it was, any more than he could drive a Jeep. Having this event fall away does not somehow miraculously make you omniscient. That's just childish mythology.

So even though we see quite a bit of evidence for something that matches the description, the obvious fact here is that the ability to access that state freely has remained completely out of reach, along with any understanding capable of robustly explaining it. Until now. And this is what I mean when I say it is a very dramatic claim. We are basically talking about an enlightened civilization in this regard, but we are also saying that the individual potential associated is not at all what we have imagined it is. It is not even spiritual at all, at least not in any mystical sense. We have completely misunderstood what this possibility actually is.

And at a more fundamental level, all of this is founded on an even more basic claim - but one that is just as unequivocal - that this added body of subversive activity really is singular and integrated and extrinsic. This is the true missing piece, because this is what delivers the important functional mechanics.

In simpler language, what this really means is that this added event is essentially like an organism. It will fight back when pushed. It will stand back up if you push it over. But more importantly, if it is pushed far enough, beyond a certain definable threshold, the entire thing will essentially fold up and die, or some functional equivalent thereof - and just like any organism when it does die, it won't ever come back again. Being pushed across that threshold is a one way trip, which is also why this subversive event will struggle violently as that moment is approached.

This is why we see so many allegorical depictions throughout history of not only the proverbial dark night of the soul just prior to this release, but in particular that this internal 'gateway to freedom' is guarded by a 'beast' of some kind - one that must be confronted and defeated - as with St George's Dragon etc, or so many other similar mythic tales. I'm sure Joseph Campbell could have rattled off a very long list.

It is a universal motif that would appear to point to an equally universal reality at the very heart of human life - a defining feature of the path we all must walk if ever we are going to be naturally happy.

It all speaks to a simple truth - that natural emotional freedom really isn't possible in the common state, not for as long as we still have this monkey on our back. And if we want to beat that monkey, we are in for a terrible fight, so it is always best to have a well trained team on your side. And that is the possibility we see emerging here for the first time. Suddenly it becomes possible to do all of this as a unified group.

In this context what it also means is that there are no half versions of this possibility, and no partial shifts in that regard. It's on or off. Like having a plant in a pot - it's either alive, or it's dead. You either have this thing, or you don't, and there really isn't any middle ground in that sense. The messy 'inbetween state' is never stable, and will always ultimately resolve back to one of the two primary states.

You can even cut this plant off right at the ground, for instance if you went to Tibet and meditated for twenty years, and it will only sprout new shoots and grow back immediately the moment you stop. So if you want to kill it, once and for all, you really need to know how it works.

And the same is true at the collective level - this great cascading collapse has either begun, or it hasn't - meaning that we either remain trapped in the common state, or that we have already entered this implacable transition process as a global civilization. Which, once again, will never occur until you know exactly where to begin that entire event.

So have we? Which is it? How would you know? Where would you look? What defines that great collective collapse?

Considering what it all means, does it sound like something you should at least be aware of? If it is happening, wouldn't you like to know? And if it isn't, wouldn't you like to make sure it does?

It really is an overwhelming proposition. For something so big to be able to come from something so small, and for so few to be able to impact the lives of so many. For all of that to just be sitting there, so obviously within the reach of even a moderate degree of collective attention, it really is a bombshell.

But do you see the big dilemma here already? This is the answer to a question you have probably already been asking yourself by now: if it is that big, and that important, then why not just make a big noise about it? Why not start a podcast, or stand up on the TED stage, as we initially imagined ourselves doing here?

There are several good reasons for this. Firstly, because doing that would have no effect at all if only because it would always fall short of the 'capture' threshold we have been indicating, which essentially represents the minimum point of understanding required to basically grasp what is being proposed.

Nobody would even hear it. I mean, if what you want is a nice warm fire out in the woods, do you hold a match against an old wet log? How many logs could you hold a match against and still get no fire? It would basically be infinite. And nobody has an infinite number of matches to waste. That's simply not how you make a fire, and that is what we already learned in relation to this point of capture.

Even in a dry situation, lighting a fire generally requires a certain concentration of heat, and a very particular setup, as indicated in our discussion about qualification, conversation, and capture. The wrong process is worthless.

You need very dry wood, in a very particular kind of arrangement, and then you need to apply intense heat in a very focused manner. Only then do things suddenly change, with the focus suddenly becoming one of how to contain the fire rather than how to generate it.

So that is the first thing - it would basically be pointless to do all of this the loud way. It would be ineffectual in any positive sense, but that would not prevent it from being offensive in a negative way.

More likely the outcome of doing that would only be shock and bewilderment at a collective level, as driven by sudden emotional crisis at the level of the individual. That is the second thing. The issue we are discussing is a very real struggle within every individual person, but it is also something they are desperately seeking to avoid.

In many ways this is the essential insight here, at least as it relates to broader culture. The environment we are accustomed to at present is not actually neutral as we imagine, in that it will always tend to infiltrate and dilute this sort of penetrating dialogue over time. So our current situation really is like trying to light a fire in the rain in this sense. There is wet wood everywhere. Which means it was always going to be very difficult at first. But the results of getting it right even once are also dramatic, which is another thing we need to prepare for.

Common culture is not neutral as we tend to imagine, it has been established over time so as to always assist us in this continual battle to stay afloat emotionally. So if ever anything even so much as hints in this direction, there is always a kind of collective immune response. And this is the third thing to consider - not only how ineffectual open propagation might be, or how much needless disruption that might generate, but also how to make the process sustainable.

From the perspective of anyone offering such an insight in the first place, how to then survive being dropped like a roast chicken into a tank full of piranhas? If it wasn't true then people would just laugh it off as being ridiculous, but people don't actually laugh. Quite the opposite.

All of this starts to make more sense once you consider the underlying situation -

In any typical context, whenever some new or important insight becomes available, you would first of all make people aware of the whole thing prior to them making any decision about it. Secondly, in almost all such cases the potential in question would only have an indirect impact on any person's psychological well-being, if any at all. But in this instance both of those factors are completely inverted. In this case the subject we are addressing is itself an active process of emotionally loaded unawareness. And what this means is that you cannot realistically make someone aware of it first, in order to allow them to then decide whether or not they would like to become aware of it. That so-called choice would obviously be an oxymoron.

This concealment is also a body of activity that stands right at the core of every person's life, something that for most people would cause immediate and profound internal disruption if ever it was suddenly exposed in the way we are suggesting. For the average person, avoiding the very thing we are pointing at here is pretty much synonymous with happiness itself. This is every person they know, and every story they tell. That's basically what their entire life is all about.

So think about the dilemma that situation represents, when you stack that ubiquitous avoidance against this need to make at least a few people aware of it. In the end what this means is that the rare few who might be able to actually do something about all of this are not currently aware that the possibility even exists. But we also can't make a big noise about it, if only because for most people

even the mere hint of that same conversation would immediately plunge them into deep emotional shock.

It might even be the ultimate puzzle - the single greatest impetus in human history being set up to confront the greatest of all barriers: a blindness in the mind of the average person, and an equally deep cultural aversion. It really does define this facilitated release as being the single greatest potential for sudden positive change we currently face, or have ever faced, or will ever face again - and the entire thing comes down to this one final challenge. We might only need to start chatting away about the whole thing in order to open it all up. That's it. And yet - not a peep. We are immediately dumbstruck, and stunned into silence, even when the offer is made. We simply can't bring ourselves to cross that line and start a simple conversation about it. The very thing we are seeking more than anything else in life appears to us as the worst thing ever at an emotional level. This is simply how it works.

Really, it would almost be humorous if it wasn't so sad - in that we are all sitting there waiting for a really big answer, a truly fundamental solution to all of our deepest and most persistent problems. And in some very real sense it was standing right in front of us the whole time. But then, the moment someone points it out, in such clear and obvious terms, we immediately run for our lives.

This is just how the trap works, as I say, and where all of humanity has been stuck for so long.

In any case, the whole prospect of any 'loud' approach would be immediately unsustainable. It would basically go nowhere, and would probably only cause more harm than good, not unless you somehow managed to reach one or two people who were capable of actually doing something about it. But what are the chances of the right fish even being able to see what you are saying once all the wrong fish have stirred up so much mud in their frenzied panic?

So how would you break such a deadlock? How to find these rare people? How to even develop that level of narrative in the first place, not really knowing who we are speaking to in that regard? And especially how to do that without plunging all the rest into some kind of deep existential crisis?

All of which leaves us to explain the only obvious solution to what might be the final hurdle in a very long string of obstacles that have already been overcome along the way here.

What we need are two things here. We first of all need to be free to apply heat in a very focused way, and without reservation. But we also need to do that within a very secure and bounded social context. And it turns out that the answer to both of these issues is the same.

If you think about our fire metaphor for a moment this might make a bit more sense. On the one hand we can focus on all the things that might be necessary to get the fire going, and you might think about that as being primary. But we also need to think about the reality of containing the resulting fire in that case, especially in light of the fact that anyone will be able to achieve this if what we are doing here ends up being even remotely successful. We therefore need to do both at the same time if any of this is going to happen in a responsible manner.

This is why we always seem to end up discussing the need for a clear cultural boundary here, and the idea of only ever having this particular conversation in a safe and isolated space - one that has been very intentionally established for that purpose.

We sometimes use the deep end of the pool as a metaphor in this regard, as indicated. You really don't want to go around throwing people who can't swim into the deep end, but you also can't really tell if anyone is going to be able to keep their head above water until you throw them in. So it is a paradox of sorts. It can be very tempting! But you also don't want to make the deep end shallow just because some people can't swim, because that would defeat the whole purpose. Anyone particularly suited to the deep might even break their neck diving into such a shallow pool, and we obviously wouldn't want that.

Basically, what we need is to put a fence up, and to erect a very clear sign, thereby giving people fair warning - thus allowing them to decide for themselves if they want to step inside that line and try it out. The same fence also allows us to keep anyone out who does not meet the minimum standards associated.

It sounds simple enough. But what does that mean, and how does it work in this context? What does it actually look like?

It looks like precisely what we are doing here, and that's why we are going to be dwelling on this point for a moment. As you can see, we have slowed down even further at this stage, as we get into the really deep mud. We might even need to get out and push as we look to surmount this one final issue.

Therefore, the fire in our metaphor is what? It is a kind of social energy. It is a deep shift in values based on the possibility of this fundamental release coming into view, but it is also a shift that can quite easily become contagious and a sense, especially at a certain level of audience - that audience being those few who are capable of truly understanding all of the deeper implications associated.

But this ethical landslide does not necessarily empower anyone to do much about it. And this is what we mean about throwing people who can't swim into the deep end. We not only need to put a fence around the pool in this regard, but we also need to build a kind of shallow end, where all those who are interested can splash about freely - and also where swimming lessons might take place.

We have been talking about two groups of people here - the givers and the receivers so to speak - and we have broadly been separating these two groups based on who might be qualified in the first instance, and also indicating just how rare those characteristics might be. But that is not the important split here. What we are actually speaking about is this moment of capture, what that really implies in this context, and also who that applies to. Pretty much anyone can cross that line and appreciate what all of this might mean, both for themselves and for the world. That part is not rare, or particularly difficult. But we really do need to clarify exactly what this shift implies, and what it basically means.

Qualification as we have been defining it is not the important distinction in this sense. Yes we are going to need that. As with every technology, a few people might make all the big advances for everyone else as they manage to extract practical applications from the theory. But a great many eminently qualified people might not be even remotely interested in this, as we'll see. That might even

be the dominant response. Whereas there appear to be a great many more who are, and who would dearly love to help, if only they knew what to do.

Basically, lots of people are easily capable of reaching this point of capture, and thereby understanding what's at stake, but many still struggle to figure out how they might meaningfully assist. Actually this appears to be the vast majority. So one important question in that regard is how to manage an event that might easily get out of control.

Once again we see the purpose of a clear cultural boundary, and also why it needs to be so clearly signposted. What we don't want is for anyone playing around in this pool to be intentionally splashing people as they walk past on their way to work. And that is what we have been explaining.

So for you personally it might be a revelation once it finally comes clearly into view, but for those around you - who have not yet encountered this shift - the same information might still be extremely toxic in the first instance. And you may not realise that you are now splashing people all around you with water they really don't appreciate.

The important thing to take into account here is how deeply that shift in perspective will impact the way you see things, and also the way you see other people. In particular, the moment you see the true nature of the situation, and our only narrow window of exit, what becomes clear is that every individual action - and every cultural transaction - either rises above or falls below the threshold associated with the ignition of this great cascading release. And the foundational nature of the issue being indicated, along with how radically concealed it has been - when then combined with how accessible the whole possibility might be - brings the initiation of this great cascade into view as the only true and worthy goal.

This individual affliction is far from being the only problem we face as a civilization, but in the scheme of things it is certainly the greatest, as well as by far the most deeply impactful at an individual level. And then for the release of all of that to be placed in the hands of just a brave few, it is an overwhelming proposition if true.

The massive moral gravity here relates in particular to how much suffering that great cascading wave stands to sweep away, and also how all of that boils down to this singular defining threshold right at the start. This is what provides for such powerful impetus. But then all of that force runs headlong into this deepest of all wounds in the heart of every individual, making it the very last thing they want to even admit to, let alone actually explore in any meaningful way.

In any case, we essentially have a situation where two very distinctly different outcome states are presented, and in a way that makes them mutually exclusive by definition. The presence of one literally implies the absence of the other.

It is not an overstatement to say that we are literally speaking about two entirely different worlds in that regard. There is the diseased world we see today, and then there is the cured world we could quite easily bring about.

In the end, with something this deep, there was always going to be a very deep cost. And yes, there is. The cost is that you can't have both. The price of the new world is letting go of the old one. And the same goes for the new self it all suggests. You can't have the light and still hold onto the darkness -

we can't all be free and yet still remain in the cage. So in the end it comes down to a choice - a choice in this case that only a few will make for everyone.

Just to be clear, then, none of this ethical consideration relates to the long term, because later all of this awareness will simply be forced onto people as a raw fact of life based on the arrival of abundant and unequivocal evidence. But in the meantime it represents a big shift, and not only in perspective, but also in terms of real practical orientation in life. So until that cascading threshold has been reached it means embracing this awareness is going to make anyone a fish out of water so to speak, if only because they will end up walking a path that is extremely divergent from the typical one, and that they can't even really explain to anyone. Not yet.

So if it turns out to be true, then in the long term it won't matter, because that choice will basically be made for you. But in the short term everyone is going to face this choice about being part of something so big at a moment when that involvement might make such a big impact.

In the end, however, the fork in the road we see emerging here will be faced by all - that if you are not very intentionally deciding to leave the trapped common bowl, then you are actively deciding to stay in it, whether you consciously own that choice or not. And the common state is the common state. There are no two versions of it. So all variations of that decision to stay are basically the same decision, no matter how you might choose to dress it up.

Therefore, we see a situation here that is unavoidably polarizing. It simply can't be helped. This is just what a really deep answer implies. It is all because the possibility is so vast, and because the necessary conditions for the initiation of that great collapse are so inimitable. This means by implication that all current paths are immediately eclipsed by this singular revelation, if only because those approaches do not include this one critical element.

Just to be clear, then - the whole thing comes as quite a shock. Especially if you are an academic, or anyone who makes their living from knowing stuff. As indicated above, what we see here is a very deep fracture that cleaves the bedrock of modern psychology right down the middle, thereby forcing us to start again in a sense. It is a ground-up rebuild in many ways.

The insight, in the form of this functional differentiation, is so fundamental that it essentially makes it inimitable. And in practice it stands to be even more dramatic. Like nuclear fission, the whole thing reveals a profound and hidden potential at the level of the individual, one that can propagate like a wave in a collective sense, thereby producing another completely different phenomenon. A kind of 'wildfire realisation'. But in just the same way, merely knowing the basic outlines isn't enough to release it. There is a certain critical mass of insight required in relation to the anatomy, and also a certain level of basic intellect associated. Which means that in the absence of such information - or such people - you really can't talk about it at all, not in any true or meaningful way.

Basically, for a little bit of theoretical input in this direction you don't get a little bit of output. You get nothing at all. And for as long as your efforts fall short of the critical threshold you will continue to see no results. Nothing. Forever.

This is what it means to be a paradigm. It means there were never going to be any incremental steps, or partial versions of this, because what defines this view is not just the idea. Anything short of the

minimum critical mass will result in no effect at all when put into practice. And that is what we see in all current psychological models - they are all nets that failed to catch the only fish that really matters in this context - the big one - and this can be very hard to accept if you happen to make a living selling sardines.

It is an integrated singularity in this sense – it was born whole, and stands alone. It does not relate to any other existing theory, religion, or cosmology. Not directly. It therefore cannot be taken in part, any more than you can order half a puppy from the pet shop. It stands freely on the foundation of science in general, as a new and far simpler way to shuffle the same old deck. It validates many empirical findings, including them within a new framework, but in the process sweeps away a great deal of unnecessary and outdated theoretical detritus.

And this is important to know right at the start, if only so as to prepare you for the gravity of what is being proposed. Overlooking this issue in the individual was an absolutely huge cultural error that will unavoidably require an absolutely huge correction, so a degree of humility will be required in that sense. And failing to say this plainly, right up front, would simply be irresponsible.

The particular location of what it reveals, and the depth of what it points at, essentially changes everything, immediately sweeping away the foundations of all views that do not include this most elementary fact. Which is, unfortunately, pretty much everything we see at present. Many views contain part of the picture, but the overall framework is what matters, and that has consistently eluded us. And as a result, this great cascading potential has remained beyond our reach.

Essentially, all actions that do not represent this rather narrow exit from the common state are failed paths by definition. The whole lot. There are no exceptions. All of that is just the same thing - the wrong thing. It really does mean that all approaches that do not explicitly aim to reach this simple but critical threshold are essentially worthless from within this emerging perspective, which at this time happens to be all of them.

This is what we mean when we say it changes everything. It isn't right that something this heavy should have been kept from us. It is a shocking revelation that leaves you in a different situation from the moment you become aware of it. It is very unfair in this sense, in that we are confronted without warning with a possibility that society never even told us was possible. It is a lot to take in, but this merely indicates the fact that you have probably not yet fully processed the implications of what is being indicated, or what a separate equilibrium really means in this sense.

In the end what this paradigm provides for is basically another whole view of life in general, and in particular one that appears to place happiness in exactly the opposite direction to the typical path. You might easily come to perceive it as being by far the most beautiful thing you have ever seen, which is kind of paradoxical given how dark it is, but all of that darkness is what stands to be removed, and that's what makes it beautiful. So the worse it is, the better, in that context. But the only true way out is to go directly toward the very thing we fear the most. And for most people - who don't really understand what's going on here - that will seem completely barbaric.

Basically, it is completely natural that most people will hate this entire thing. Billions of people will hate it at first. It is inevitable under the circumstances. But that is only because it is a very fierce mirror, and because people don't generally like what they see when they look. And the obvious answer to that

question is to simply not show them. The vast majority of people can, ideally, remain blissfully unaware of this entire possibility.

For most people, the big personal gains associated with this emerging potential will only be embraced at the downstream stage, once they are being delivered freely to the masses. And being an icebreaker in that context wouldn't even occur to them. It would make no sense at all to sacrifice even a small degree of their personal comfort for a greater good, no matter how big the collective gains might be. For almost all people life is just about enjoying themselves, rather than making any kind of difference. That is simply the level of moral development most people are stuck at. It is all about them personally. That is literally all they know, all they can see, and all they care about. That is their whole life.

This is simply what it means to be living in the galactic asylum for the criminally immature. So you wouldn't even be able to explain such a path to them. Not ethically. Not beyond a certain introductory gesture, as we have seen here. This is the very point we are making. Even with this presentation itself we run the risk of saying too much, or too clearly, and thereby sending anyone particularly fragile into an emotional tailspin.

And yet, there is no judgement implied in that determination. That state of avoidant hostility is not actually native to anyone, and they shouldn't be blamed. That's completely normal under the circumstances, and does not represent a problem with people at all. Not really. That's just the disease, doing what the disease does. This unconscious reflex to pull away is just a fact of life in light of an insight that corrects such a deep cultural error. This is exactly the reaction the model predicts, and we can't really complain about people having the very thing we're seeking to explain.

Therefore, this erosion of normal development is simply something we have to accept, and somehow work around. It's just that most people have been bitten more deeply, which can make them harder to shake out of the trance. And that's fine. They will remain trapped within this bubble of existential disorientation and dread until help arrives in a form they can recognise. All that means is that they will catch all of this in the next wave, when it arrives in completely different terms.

Even the very definition of what love is ends up being called into question here. The middle of the common bowl and the point of exit from that bowl are literally as far apart as they can be from an emotional and cultural standpoint, so if someone had no idea that another entire equilibrium exists then they would only imagine you are insane if you were heading off toward that peak of tension.

That's how deeply invested people are in this underlying process of avoidance, and how much it dominates their every thought and action. All the 'happy and healthy' people are clustered around the middle of the trapped common bowl, at the point of lowest tension. That's where all the 'influencers' live their inane and morally myopic lives. The 'avoidance of all demand' is the tune everyone is humming without even knowing it, and the moment you start singing a different tune you are a heretic, an abstainer, a traitor of the highest order - and into the oven you go.

Basically, the deep end is deep. And I'm sure this sounds trite, and for anyone who can swim in this sense that is probably true. But if you can't swim, then ending up in the same deep water - morally speaking - might be the single worst experience of your life.

This explains how best to approach all of it. This explains how to get all the good stuff while at the same time avoiding all the bad. The key is simply to approach the whole thing with clear mutual respect, as indicated. And you already know how to do that, but in this instance - given what's at stake - it seems to be worth spelling it out very clearly.

Just think of it in the same way you might approach an extreme sport. Imagine you discovered naked skydiving. That sounds pretty radical? But that's not even close to the level of extreme we are talking about here. This is by far the deepest decision someone will ever make in life, which is why it is not a decision you can ever make for anyone else.

So think about it that way. If you did discover such a passion, would you need to do it all day every day? No. Would you post pictures on instagram of yourself doing naked skydiving? No. Would you suggest that everyone should try it out, or grab random people off the street and throw them out of a plane, without asking their consent first? Obviously not.

It would simply be something that you personally enjoyed doing, as and where appropriate, most likely on a Sunday afternoon for a couple of hours, and only ever with other freaks who happen to have discovered a similar passion for the same extreme pursuit.

However, we also see the other side of the same coin here, in that you would obviously never want to go skydiving in a casual or reckless way. Would you want to do that with anyone drunk, or with anyone particularly stupid? Is skydiving something you would ever want to half-do? No.

This is also the purpose and function of the boundary. From the outside as a beginner it is about informed consent. But as a veteran skydiver it is also about respecting reality, in light of the extreme nature of what is being indicated.

The point is that there are many things in the real world that can only be done fully, or not at all. You cannot do them by half, not without completely losing the benefits, or perhaps even resulting in outcomes that are far worse than doing nothing.

So the purpose of this cultural threshold is also to set a clear tone. The idea is to curate a space, and to provide a filter - a selective barrier to entry. All of which means that there needs to be minimum standards associated.

The point is that this important cultural boundary has to go both ways. It needs to allow all those who clearly qualify access to the deep end of the pool, but it must also pull people who can't swim out of the water when necessary.

Basically, there is no point whatsoever in embracing any level of transaction that very clearly falls below the minimum standard required to meet the actual demands associated with the territory implied, so that's what this boundary needs to represent. The bar cannot be lowered in this sense just because someone can't jump it. And yes, we are talking about open discrimination here. Everyone is being invited, but not all behavior can be accepted. Not at first. That is precisely what the establishment of this boundary means, and why we are taking so much time here to explain it.

It's like a fire box - it is implied that everything inside the box will be on fire, while everything outside the box will not. That's the whole point of it. And with so much at stake - with literally the fate of the

world in the balance - it would be clearly irresponsible to remain engaged with anything lower than the required minimum in any such context. We already tried that here, and it cost us decades of wasted time and energy. So that path has been entirely spent.

The whole idea that 'everyone is equal' doesn't really work when you are dealing with science or technology, because in that case you are dealing with reality, not any artificially constructed social hothouse where even the most fragile of flowers might find a quiet corner to thrive. There are always real external demands associated with real world events, so real standards must apply. And all those who do not meet those standards must be politely excluded, and respectfully left in peace.

It can be difficult to achieve this basic function without being too blunt, but in the end it is not really hostile in any sense. It is only a failure to respect such a boundary that is hostile.

If we go back to our analogy of lighting a fire in the rain, how would you do that? First of all you would build some kind of shelter, right? Then you would very carefully select a few bits of wood, and begin to dry them out. And then you would use just the right process, in just the right way, in order to get only a tiny little ember going. And then, from that little ember you would quickly get a flame, and from that flame you would quickly get a fire, at which point everything would change. If people had never seen fire before then suddenly their eyes would be bulging, as they tried to grasp what they were looking at, and what it all might mean.

The point is that - from that moment forward - fire would no longer be a problem, because both the drying and igniting of timber would then be easy. The main problem by that stage might no longer be so much about how to get the fire going, but how to keep it safely contained. You would have a whole new set of problems to deal with at that point, and if you hadn't prepared for those in advance, then you might be in a bit of trouble. So that preparation is what we are doing here.

In any case, it all begins with this initial shelter. And that's all we mean when we talk about cultural isolation. That's what this boundary is. It doesn't imply exclusion at all. All people are invited. Anyone can step under this shelter if they wish, just as long as they don't insult that hospitality by immediately poking holes in it. And that's what happens whenever weakness is respected rather than challenged - it immediately destroys the entire function of the context. So it's altogether easier in the end to take a moment to put up a very clear signpost, rather than throw anyone out later. Just like the fence around a pool - it merely signifies the application of certain rigorous standards within a clearly bounded space, and all for a very particular purpose.

So hopefully that signpost is doing its job here by explaining both the fun and the danger of the deep end being indicated. In many ways it can be devastating to become aware of something this profound. It can even be impossible to be happy once you see this great cascade, and just how near it is to being opened up, especially if this has not yet occurred. Indeed, just the idea that our brief window of opportunity could still be lost here if we are not careful might easily keep you awake at night.

So there can be a very powerful tendency to want to shout about it. It can make you want to explode, and to scream it in the streets. It is just so overwhelmingly dramatic. But that is an impulse you really need to resist in this instance, which is precisely what we are saying here. That would only make it worse, not better. It's just not that sort of thing.

It is all just to establish this small and clearly bounded space, so as to protect people on both sides of that line from conflict and misunderstanding. Like a cozy fire and an old armchair, typical culture and this newly emerging event are entirely complementary to each other, they both stand to benefit, but only provided they can always be kept sufficiently apart. So the very last thing this needs is a whole bunch of fanatical zealots running around throwing heirloom furniture onto the fire, or even worse - throwing flaming logs around the living room.

Science does not require 'believers', and in this sense the big danger is not so much that nobody might be interested, but that certain people might be altogether too interested, but in all the wrong ways. There is nobody to follow here.

This is a very important thing to understand, and perhaps why we are making so much noise here at the start, as we reach the point where anyone might be thinking about wading in a little deeper: what we see emerging here is not a social movement. It does not need to be popular, nor require broad attention. There is no sense here that most people should even be made aware, and nobody should ever be pressed toward it.

This is what confuses people at first, until they grasp the essential power of the framework - that it points to an emerging technology, rather than any kind of philosophy. There is no political dimension whatsoever.

Common culture is not being implicated here in any direct way, and nothing needs to change in that regard. Quite the opposite, we really need for everything we see - with all of its stable containment - to remain completely untouched and unaffected by whatever emerges here in the short term, at least until all of this reaches a point of stable deployment in practice.

This is why every person needs to be able to make that decision for themselves in full awareness, and to simply walk away if they wish. They need to be able to take a look, and make that determination on their own, without coercion or pressure of any kind. Which means the only thing you can do is walk the fine line we are doing here, by offering just enough information to bring them to the edge of that precipice, but not quite enough to push them over it.

You might even be feeling a bit frustrated at this moment, as if we are talking a lot but never really getting to the point. But this is intentional. That's what respect looks like in such a profound context, when awareness itself is the subject at hand. I am very deliberately not giving you quite enough information here to fully grasp what I am saying - but still hopefully enough to make sure you are getting the general idea.

This is the delicate balance we are seeking to achieve here. That's the thing that, hopefully at least, makes this safe but also effective. This is a public version, so it needs to be like a rubber bullet in that context, designed to be shot out into the world freely, but without anyone getting hurt. There are a few such works available now, this is just the latest attempt at knocking people over with a marshmallow. It never really works very well for this reason.

But don't worry, that will all change very quickly if ever you decide to sit down and chat about it more directly. It won't be like this at all. Suddenly it will be a lot more like sitting across the table from a howitzer, and without even trying.

Just the willingness to talk about it really does change the whole game. That's just what happens the moment you have it going both ways. And I suppose that's what you are being warned about. This is only the ticket, not the ride. But in this case the ticket needs to have a big warning stamped on it, because some people are simply too fragile for the rollercoaster associated - and you really can't get off that ride once it begins.

On screen: The Final Lesson: Born That Way

Surely you have to be asking yourself by now whether I actually believe anything I am saying here. But yes, I really do. And not because I haven't questioned it. For years I have been trying to pull it all apart, like a drowning man reaching for air, but no luck so far. So these days I don't doubt that it is true at all, if only because all such doubt has now been fully spent.

I think that 'sudden and permanent release' possibility is absolutely a reality for every person. I think they really do suffer from exactly what is being described here, exactly the way it is being explained. Which means that this potential for relinquishment is just sitting there in every individual person, like a cherry waiting to be picked. And I also think there really is every possibility that various kinds of collective development could make that potential both accessible going in the front end, as well as comprehensively explain the results of that transition as people come out the back end. But most importantly of all, if this occurred - even once in a controlled context - that it would immediately begin to cascade. The spiral of development associated would then expand without obvious limit until all the fuel associated had been consumed - that fuel in this case being deep human suffering and struggle.

Yes, I believe this. I also believe that we now only need the map to be rendered in the right terms, and that the only thing required for that will be to bounce the whole thing off a few of the right people.

But what I don't believe in is that people are going to rise to this challenge. I don't believe this at all. I have zero faith that anyone will rise to the demands associated, even though - from my perspective - they seem so very low. And I don't believe this based on a huge amount of evidence and experience.

So the only thing we can hope for here is that my perceptions are biased, and that they are just the result of having been very distorted over time.

In the end it is all in the hands of these rare individuals. The whole thing has now come down to this one final step, the only one that I can't do myself, if only because it is collective by definition. The entire world really could change if only we hit that one small target, again and again, until the whole thing blows open once and for all.

Nobody can make them step up to the demands associated. We don't even know if they are out there, not in the numbers this will require, or whether they are going to be capable of working together in the way it will demand. It will be up to them to take a look at what we manage to expose here and decide that for themselves. But more importantly, nobody can stop them if they do want to. It is a rare situation in this sense, where we get to witness the dominance of the higher, rather than the dominance of the lower, as we normally see. It is a situation where just a few people might be able to impose massive positive change on a deeply suffering world, merely by providing overwhelming gain to billions, at almost no cost.

We just didn't know it was there. But now we do. And the moment it is confirmed in practical terms - and it certainly could be - the entire thing will begin to release, for everyone, in a truly global sense. There will be no containing it. So that becomes the obvious aim.

It basically sets all of that up like a great boulder that is teetering on a mountain top, just waiting for a single small push in the right spot. And in this case that small push now appears to be nothing more than our ability to find and appropriately inform these rare individuals.

So who are we looking for here? How would you recognise them?

These people may not be who you imagine. To be truly qualified for what is emerging here might not even make you particularly capable in any normal worldly sense, it might just make you a bit odd. It is a rare psychological combination. They might be blisteringly smart in certain regards, but they may also clearly be on fire in some sense. It is not easy being extremely sensitive as well as mostly naked, as you walk through such a hostile world.

Many such people may even have suffered deeply in order to maintain the very things that will set them apart in this emerging arena. But actually these people have a latent superpower in this context, one they probably didn't even know they carried.

What makes you more receptive to this information could even be that this internal subversion is not quite working correctly for you, and perhaps never did. We tend to call this receptivity 'the right stuff' in this context, and in that sense these people might even be less than the average person, rather than more. It is almost as if the psychological bunker we are all hiding in is a bit broken for these people, so that they can see a bit of light through the cracks. They already know at some level that the small emotional space they are crammed into is not the whole picture, and that there is definitely something else beyond. So for them it is no surprise. Whereas for most people the comfortable inside of their little emotional cell is all they know, and they really don't like being disturbed by thoughts of anything more. All those people want is to be left alone, and to go on back to sleep. And we should let them.

Here we also strike a far wider issue we have been hinting at, but which we have not really stated explicitly. Which is that 'capture' and 'qualification' tend to be diametrically opposed.

You would imagine that academics would be the most highly qualified in such an arena, and in a sense that is actually true, but only at a purely intellectual level. Which would be fine, except that this is not just an idea. It is not even primarily an idea, with the only truly important aspect being the difference it might make in the real world, and in the direct real-life experience of individuals everywhere. It is not academic at all, and this can be a challenge for anyone overly egg-headed or abstract in their approach to life.

The problem with a very high degree of functional integrity, especially at an intellectual level, is that it will necessarily demand tremendous force be applied over time by this subversive agenda in other areas of the system. As we have indicated - the bigger they are, the harder they fall. So higher cognition basically creates an internal war, and this is why lots of really smart people don't seem much happier than most - not unless they have balanced the books somehow in this way, ethically speaking.

Which leaves us with a kind of paradox once again, in that the only ones with the power to make a really big difference are rarely inclined to do so. This inertia is just the price these people pay for that power.

This dynamic concealment activity basically likes to keep us as dumb as it can, without completely destroying our life. This is one of its main impacts. But if it is not being allowed to do that in one important area of functioning, it will always need to adopt more strident measures elsewhere. So if you shrink or amputate one limb of this octopus, the other limbs will only grow to maintain overall balance. And in general, what this means is that high intellectual development tends to come at the cost of high moral engagement, if only because with power comes responsibility, and because intelligence is nothing if it is not power.

So wherever we see the arising of high intellectual development, we also tend to see it being born like a conjoined twin, with the other sibling being powerful moral inertia. Basically, the bigger your head grows, the smaller your testicles will tend to become, so to speak - or whatever the female equivalent of that might be. And once again, this sounds terrible, but it is also completely obvious if you look around. It simply has to be this way, in order to prevent such people from taking on all the problems of the world. We even have special containment facilities for such people, which we tend to call 'universities'.

But all dark humour aside for a moment, it really is true that receptivity and capability are rarely found together in this sense. Which also implies that really smart people can be very hard nuts to crack. But that's not actually a problem. This is part of what makes them smart. But it can be very hard to even get them through the door in the first place. Why? Because it isn't true? No, it seems to be quite the opposite. It is precisely because they sense where all of this is going, and that it's not just a bit of interesting theory.

Which in turn begins to explain once again where all of this had been hidden, along with what solving this problem is going to demand. Really smart people will always tend to ferociously avoid anything that might actually be lining up to make a big difference in the real world. After all, they aren't stupid, and nothing is more dangerous than initiating an unstoppable process of deep level collective change.

So anyway, this is the one lasting puzzle we are left to solve, as the search begins for who these people might be. Where are the people with both balls and brains? Probably not in universities! It is a combination that makes them a very rare bird indeed.

Therefore, how do you know if you qualify for 2EQ? It's very simple. You will not immediately assume that it will be someone else that will ignite this whole thing. On the contrary, you immediately understand that it must be you, that it can only be you, and that it was always going to be you.

It's you. Yes you. Of course it is you, in just the same way as it was me. Who did you think it was going to be? Who is going to change the world, if not you?

This was the lesson we learned here, the hardest one of all. And we have been skirting around this issue here also, but once again it probably needs to be stated plainly. The factors that define someone as ready for this level of impact appear to be baked in - dyed in the wool so to speak - and cannot be stimulated in any external way. Patience also won't help, so there is no point waiting for someone.

This is the bedrock here, and this also accounts for the strong message about never randomly promoting this paradigm, as if it was a weight that anyone might be able to lift. It isn't, and you will very soon find this out if ever you do share it in any blithely indiscriminate manner. Some people just aren't strong enough to know this. Not during the initial stages, where all the really important things will happen. As they used to say - "The pioneers take the arrows - the settlers take the land".

This balance cannot be adjusted in anyone, not from the outside. Moral development is at the top of all psychological hierarchies, it is an advanced faculty - developed at great cost, and carried at great expense - and therefore cannot simply be demanded from anyone who doesn't obviously possess it already.

Put bluntly, the people we are looking for here cannot be made - they can only be found. They are simply born that way, built for this task, just as I was. Recognition will be immediate, and interest will not need to be stoked. So if that's not the response you get from anyone, then just let it go, and move on. That's not the right fish.

So here we also see the primary injunction in its most simple terms: Share this. Feel free. That's the only reason you are reading it in the end, unless you yourself happen to be one of these rare few. But only ever share it with one person - that person being the single smartest and most capable person you know.

But won't this limit its spread? Yes. That would be the whole point. This game is all about quality, not quantity. We really are only talking about a handful of people here, they just need to be the right people. So if we end up with only a dozen people in the room, that would be great. That will be more than enough. It is all about depth, not span.

So that would be my only request if ever you felt inclined to assist in any way. Pass it upwards - but only once, to the best of the best only. If you did only that, then the great cascade we have been alluding to would be absolutely assured before long.

Choose wisely, pass it on personally, and never knock twice. Don't bug anyone with this in any repeated way, and never offer it to someone you don't know. Given the central subject matter, doing that might even be considered philosophical terrorism, especially if someone isn't obviously interested, or well prepared. Once is a gift, especially if your aim is good, in which case you will never need to say it twice. But twice would probably be abuse. Which means you really only get one shot. When someone is ready for this, they are always ready immediately.

So that's the game. It needs to be passed upwards. And who is going to do that? You are. And if not you, then who? We stand at a kind of crossroads in this sense. We have a single task remaining. The only conversation that really needs to be happening is not happening anywhere. We just don't know who those rare people are, so we need to somehow make them aware that this missing information has now arrived.

That's it. The only game in town. We need only find the few among us who happen to be just that little bit clearer than most, that little bit more honest, and that little bit less afraid - and begin to explain it all at that level. To begin the conversation. And then to do that again, and again, until those footprints become a path, and the path becomes a road, and the road becomes a highway.

That is the whole picture. The only thing that really needs to occur now, in order for that Wright brothers threshold to become inevitable, is for the right information to be placed in the hands of the right people in the right terms. That's all. It is all about providing an opportunity for the right people to exercise the benefit of the doubt - until that doubt is either confirmed or exhausted.

Something this dramatic really needs to be challenged, both rigorously as well as rationally, rather than simply accepted by anyone. Only a complete idiot would simply swallow a claim so dramatic. It needs to be able to take the heat, which it can. So people need to bring the heat.

Robust debate is the whole point in the first instance. The idea is to challenge it. Not to avoid doubt, but to champion doubt. So if you think you can find fault with it, even prior to that point of capture being reached in your own case, then certainly - feel free. So far nobody has been able to put a dent in it, but you might be the first. That would be very interesting to see. We certainly welcome any rebuttal in that sense, provided it is rational and empirical in nature.

Of course, any sort of septic emotional discharge obviously wouldn't count as a challenge in this regard, because in this instance that would only be further proof. There is a big difference between loaded denial and rigorous challenge.

The benefit of the doubt is your ticket to entry, and what that means in this context is to at least entertain the possibility that all of this might be basically right. This does not mean to embrace the position, but it does mean weighing it up fairly - to first of all accept that you might indeed be harbouring very deep tendencies to simply respond in an entirely irrational and emotional manner. This is precisely the toxic impulse you will need to transcend as you splash around in the shallow end and gradually learn to swim. It means to embrace the possibility that it is all a lie, but also to remain open to the possibility that it might be true, until one of those propositions overcomes the other.

Sooner or later a decision will be reached in every case. And at that point - for anyone who has made it that far - it will all need to start moving into the deep end, rather than foundering around in the shallows as we see here. This was just a taste in that sense. This is not what it really looks like. In this shallow form it is all quite safe, but in conversation it is a lot more powerful, which is why that becomes the path forward.

Just to be clear, however, we should have no illusions about what that deeper exploration actually means in the first instance. What we are not doing here is recruiting anyone. There is nothing to do, not yet. And by the time there is something to do, it will already be happening, most likely elsewhere. Perhaps even everywhere.

This is the key thing - it was only awareness that was missing. So all we are doing is shining a light in the first instance. Nothing more. That's all we are doing as we head into that jungle - just making the map. The journey that map suggests will occur later. That part would already be occurring now if only anyone could see what is really going on behind the unconscious curtain. So all we are doing is taking a closer look.

At this initial stage it is all just about learning to reach this point of capture at the right level. Again and again. All the rest will arrive automatically once these initial adventures open all the territory up in the right terms. So at this stage all we really need are the right people to be asking the right questions and

to go far enough to at least be able to say they've really grasped what is being proposed. That's it. A free tour. To have the whole thing personally fitted, but then to be released immediately from any further obligation.

Think of it - all of the epic weight of moral force we have been defining, and for you to have done your bit completely merely by taking a closer look. It is the chance of a lifetime. For the first few it will be like picking up diamonds on the beach, and being allowed to take them home. It isn't difficult at all. But it does still require bravery, and honesty, as implied merely by the nature of the territory being explored.

So the next stage in, what will that look like? Who will the Wright brothers be in this arena? We really have no idea. And we probably don't need to know, any more than they needed to know about Jumbo jets. All of that is just the inevitable downstream outflow from this singular upstream shift. That will all arise immediately in the wake of any sufficiently clear explanation of what is really going on. For now we have a much simpler task - to just poke around a bit, and take a look. To draw the map.

Basically, by the time you are ready to know such things, you will no longer need to be told.

Which I suppose only leaves us to think about who those rare people might be. Amongst all of those splashing around in the shallows, who are the few who are going to venture into the deep end here? And how might we increase our chances of catching a few more of those adventurous types?

We basically need to start talking, really talking, or at the very least chatting away in the forums - and that conversation needs to move upwards as fast as possible. That's all there is to it. With just that tiny spark we might even end thousands of years of suffering with a single brave act. We are an inch away from changing the entire world here - and the bit that comes next is you.

Conversation was the missing piece in the end. Silence has been the issue - endless silence. The vacuum is where this beast thrives. Cowardice is its main source of vital energy. It feeds on fear, and in this world what that means is that this beast is perpetually fat and happy. But nothing defeats it like open-ended communal exploration guided by a clear map, in the company of the right people. So if all you do is talk about it with a few people then you will be most of the way there, because that will lead to insight, insight will lead to power, and power will lead to freedom.

Don't believe it. Just try it - and you will see for yourself. It's not even difficult, not if you are ready. It is the single most important fact of your life, why would it not be the single most important topic of conversation? That's all it means to cross this cultural threshold and enter an entirely new world. So if you just do that one thing, all the rest will be assured.

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